ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR RETAIL AND DIGITAL COMMERCE TEAMS

Retail and E-Commerce English

Explain the offer. Trace the order. Make the numbers meaningful.



Phil Stilwell

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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

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02 Pricing, Promotions, and Margin, page 14

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03 Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment, page 26

Translate inventory states into an accurate location-specific availability message.

04 Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns, page 36

Acknowledge a missed delivery estimate, distinguish shipment from arrival, and explain a concrete follow-up.

05 Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics, page 48

Report a conversion change accurately and distinguish an observed association from a causal claim.

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Challenge a vendor scorecard by specifying the unit, denominator, period, and comparison limits.

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Acknowledge a customer request, explain a bounded exception review, and distinguish policy from applicable rights.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Connect the commercial claim to the customer experience

Retail teams move between units, orders, prices, stock states, and customer promises. These conversations practice making each distinction clear while keeping the next action useful.

Name the measure before the result

Revenue, gross profit, units, and conversion answer different questions. State the denominator and comparison period before drawing a conclusion.
"Units increased, but gross profit fell on the stated cost basis."

Locate the stock behind the promise

A national total does not establish availability at a pickup store. Check the item, location, inventory state, and fulfillment route.
"Thirty units are available at the warehouse; this store has none."

Make uncertainty useful

An honest delivery update combines the latest verified status with a named next step. Do not turn an estimated arrival into a guarantee.
"The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time; I will update you at two."

Separate authority from empathy

Acknowledge the inconvenience without inventing a refund, replacement, or policy exception. Explain available review routes and applicable customer rights.
"I can submit the exception request, but I cannot approve it myself."

> ### Professional boundaries
>
> All companies, customers, products, figures, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal, accounting, or operational advice. Actual consumer rights, return obligations, marketplace terms, and shipping requirements depend on the transaction and jurisdiction. Store policies do not override applicable rights. Software terminology varies by platform.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / MERCHANDISING AND ASSORTMENT PLANNING

Compare product ranges using a defined sell-through measure and a balanced buying recommendation.

> **Equal revenue, different stock exposure**
>
> During the same four-week season, Range A sold 80 of its 100 opening units for $12,000. Range B sold 120 of its 200 opening units, also for $12,000. There were no receipts, returns, or stock adjustments. A sold at full price; B required markdowns. For this review, unit sell-through means units sold divided by opening units. Buyer Inez and planner Cal must discuss next season without assuming that equal revenue means equal performance. Product costs and customer-segment evidence are not yet available.

People: Inez, Buyer; Cal, Merchandise planner.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

A. 60%
B. 40%
C. 120%
D. 80%

2. How many units remain in Range B?

A. 80
B. 20
C. 120
D. 200

3. What is not yet established?

A. Range B used markdowns
B. Range A sold 80 units
C. Which range has higher gross profit
D. Both ranges earned $12,000 revenue

Answers and explanations, page 107

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

assortment
The selection of products offered to customers.
review the assortment

stock-keeping unit (SKU)
An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant.
rationalize the SKU count

opening stock
Inventory held at the start of a period.
establish opening stock

markdown
A reduction from an earlier selling price.
take a markdown

option count
The number of distinct product choices in a range.
review the option count

assortment depth
The variety of options within a product category or line, distinct from units held per option.
adjust assortment depth

range
A related group of products offered for sale.
compare product ranges

sell-through
Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base.
calculate unit sell-through

residual stock
Inventory remaining after the measured selling period.
reduce residual stock

full-price sale
A sale at the regular undiscounted price.
protect full-price sales

assortment breadth
The variety of categories or product choices offered.
broaden the assortment

size curve
The planned distribution of units across sizes.
revise the size curve

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

assortment ASSORTMENT

review the assortment

Keep the meaning precise: The selection of products offered to customers.

residual stock RESIDUAL STOCK

reduce residual stock

Keep the meaning precise: Inventory remaining after the measured selling period.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

colorway
A particular color version of a product.
add a colorway

core line
A recurring product line central to the offer.
replenish a core line

seasonal line
A line intended for a particular selling season.
exit a seasonal line

range review
A structured assessment of the product selection.
conduct a range review

buying budget
Funds allocated to purchasing merchandise.
protect the buying budget

open-to-buy
A planned merchandise purchasing allowance after commitments.
check open-to-buy

stock turn
A measure of how frequently inventory is sold or replaced.
compare stock turn

weeks of cover
Stock expressed in weeks at a specified sales rate.
assess weeks of cover

gross margin return on inventory
Gross profit relative to average inventory cost.
evaluate inventory return

delist
Remove an item from the active product selection.
propose a delisting

range rationalization
Simplifying the assortment using stated commercial criteria.
support range rationalization

customer segment
A group of customers with relevant shared characteristics.
serve a customer segment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

size curve SIZE CURVE

revise the size curve

Keep the meaning precise: The planned distribution of units across sizes.

buying budget BUYING BUDGET

protect the buying budget

Keep the meaning precise: Funds allocated to purchasing merchandise.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Open the comparison
Both ranges generated $12,000 in the same four weeks.

Define the measure
Here, sell-through uses units sold divided by opening stock.

State the stronger rate
Range A sold through at eighty percent.

State the remaining exposure
Range B still has eighty units on hand.

Acknowledge the commercial role
B may serve a different customer segment.

Separate units and revenue
More units sold does not necessarily mean more revenue.

Identify the price effect
B reached the same revenue with markdowns.

Ask for the missing basis
Can we add product costs before comparing gross profit?

Avoid an automatic decision
This is not enough evidence to delist the whole range.

Narrow the next review
Let us examine B by size and colorway.

Protect a useful distinction
The rate is lower even though unit sales are higher.

Request comparable periods
Keep both ranges on the same four-week basis.

Limit the recommendation
I recommend a more targeted buy, subject to the missing evidence.

Clarify commitment
A proposal is not a released purchase order.

Preserve the customer question
We still need to understand which customers bought B.

Summarize the trade-off
The same revenue came with different stock and price exposure.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the remaining exposure
Useful wording: Range B still has eighty units on hand.

Purpose: Acknowledge the commercial role
Useful wording: B may serve a different customer segment.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.

B. A sold fewer units, so its sell-through must be lower.

C. Both sell-through rates are equal because revenue is equal.

D. B sold 120%, using A's opening stock.

2. Which claim needs product costs?

A. B required markdowns.

B. A earned more gross profit than B.

C. B sold 120 units.

D. A had 20 units remaining.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base. Which term fits?

A. gross margin return on inventory

B. sell-through

C. option count

D. seasonal line

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season." Cal: [missing response] Inez: "Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will add gross margin return on inventory once we have the required cost and average-stock information. I will not manufacture it from these sales totals.

B. Agreed, but B also leaves more residual stock. We have eighty units remaining there, compared with twenty in A. Those units still need a commercial plan.

C. Yes, include the customer segment evidence. We should not describe B as unnecessary until we understand its role. That is a separate question from this period's lower rate.

D. Exactly. The markdown helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.

Answers and explanations, page 107

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Sell-through definitions differ. This case uses units sold divided by opening units, with no other stock movements. A is 80%; B is 60%. Do not quietly substitute revenue or remaining units as the denominator.

E Conversation

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

sell-through / size curve / assortment depth / customer segment / range review / residual stock / buying budget / delisting / markdown / gross margin return on inventory

01 **Inez:** Both ranges brought in twelve thousand. Can we repeat the buy? B needed more promotional support, but I do not want to cut a range customers still use.

02 **Cal:** Before we repeat the buy, look at [1] _____. A sold eighty of one hundred units; B sold one hundred twenty of two hundred. That gives eighty percent and sixty percent respectively.

03 **Inez:** B did sell forty more units. I do not want the team to lose sight of that demand when we review the range.

04 **Cal:** Agreed, but B also leaves more [2] _____. We have eighty units remaining there, compared with twenty in A. Those units still need a commercial plan.

05 **Inez:** We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season.

06 **Cal:** Exactly. The [3] _____ helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.

07 **Inez:** Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve.

08 **Cal:** I would not recommend an immediate [4] _____. First, separate B by size and colorway. An aggregate result can hide strong variants alongside weak ones.

09 **Inez:** Some sizes may be carrying the leftovers. We should see whether the original distribution matched what customers actually selected.

10 **Cal:** Then review the [5] _____. That may support changing quantities within the range rather than removing every option. We need the variant-level data before deciding.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Inez:** I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap.

12 **Cal:** Yes, include the [6] _____ evidence. We should not describe B as unnecessary until we understand its role. That is a separate question from this period's lower rate.

13 **Inez:** Could we call for a smaller initial order, with more room to react later?

14 **Cal:** We can propose that within the [7] _____, but supplier lead times and minimum quantities still need checking. Flexibility on paper is not always available in the supply arrangement.

15 **Inez:** Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately.

16 **Cal:** I will add [8] _____ once we have the required cost and average-stock information. I will not manufacture it from these sales totals.

17 **Inez:** Good. Keep the four-week dates visible so we do not compare a full season with a partial one.

18 **Cal:** The [9] _____ will show common dates, both denominators, the price reductions, and the outstanding analysis. That makes the recommendation easier to challenge constructively.

19 **Inez:** Hold the repeat order, then. Bring me the size and color breakdown with costs before we decide which options to keep.

20 **Cal:** Correct. We can revisit [10] _____ after that review, alongside quantities per option. Equal revenue is the starting observation, not the final buying decision.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. sell-through / **2.** residual stock / **3.** markdown / **4.** delisting / **5.** size curve / **6.** customer segment / **7.** buying budget / **8.** gross margin return on inventory / **9.** range review / **10.** assortment depth

Why these answers fit, page 108

F Check accuracy and scope

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

Return to the case

During the same four-week season, Range A sold 80 of its 100 opening units for $12,000. Range B sold 120 of its 200 opening units, also for $12,000. There were no receipts, returns, or stock adjustments. A sold at full price; B required markdowns. For this review, unit sell-through means units sold divided by opening units. Buyer Inez and planner Cal must discuss next season without assuming that equal revenue means equal performance. Product costs and customer-segment evidence are not yet available.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

A. Double B solely because it sold more units.
B. Treat equal revenue as proof of equal inventory return.
C. Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.
D. Delist every B item because one period proves no demand.

2. Which wording states a condition?

A. The review guarantees higher future sales.
B. We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.
C. We have already released the order.
D. Every missing cost is zero.

Answers and explanations, page 110

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep the next buy conditional on the cost and variant review.

Challenge the measure, not the buyer

A range can matter for customer choice even when its stock turns slowly. Recognize that commercial purpose, then identify the missing evidence. A precise question about margin or remaining stock is more useful than calling a colleague's selection a failure.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Compare a second pair of ranges

Range C sells 45 of 60 opening units. Range D sells 60 of 120 opening units. There are no other stock movements. Use the same unit sell-through definition.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

15 / 75% / 50% / 60

01 **Buyer:** C has a sell-through rate of [1] _____.

02 **Planner:** D has a sell-through rate of [2] _____.

03 **Buyer:** C has [3] _____ units remaining.

04 **Planner:** D has [4] _____ units remaining.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 75% / **2.** 50% / **3.** 15 / **4.** 60

Why these answers fit, page 110

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "Could we call for a smaller initial order, with more room to react later?" Cal: [missing response] Inez: "Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes, include the customer segment evidence. We should not describe B as unnecessary until we understand its role. That is a separate question from this period's lower rate.

B. Before we repeat the buy, look at sell-through. A sold eighty of one hundred units; B sold one hundred twenty of two hundred. That gives eighty percent and sixty percent respectively.

C. Exactly. The markdown helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.

D. We can propose that within the buying budget, but supplier lead times and minimum quantities still need checking. Flexibility on paper is not always available in the supply arrangement.

Answers and explanations, page 111

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / PRICING, PROMOTIONS, AND MARGIN

Explain price-volume arithmetic and challenge a profit claim without dismissing the promotion goal.

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

In the baseline week, a product sold 100 units at $50 each. During the promotion it sold 120 units at $42.50 each, a 15% price reduction. Product cost remained $30 per unit. These are complete comparable weekly sales with no returns. Taxes, shipping income, operating expenses, and other promotional costs are excluded. Trading manager Hugo says the 20% unit increase proves that profit improved. Finance partner Nia must correct that claim and separate the measured result from other possible campaign objectives.

People: Hugo, Trading manager; Nia, Finance partner.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What was promotion revenue?

A. $5,100
B. $6,000
C. $4,250
D. $5,000

2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

A. $2,400
B. $5,100
C. $1,500
D. $2,000

3. Which cost is excluded?

A. The $30 unit product cost
B. Cost of all 120 units sold
C. Cost of baseline units sold
D. Operating expenses

Answers and explanations, page 112

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

selling price
The amount charged per unit before specified adjustments.

set the selling price

sales revenue
Income from the measured sales before the stated costs.

calculate sales revenue

gross profit
Sales revenue less cost of goods sold.

protect gross profit

price reduction
A decrease in the selling price.

apply a price reduction

baseline
The reference level used for comparison.

establish a baseline

unit gross profit
Selling price less the stated product cost per unit.

compare unit gross profit

unit volume
The number of units sold during a period.

increase unit volume

cost of goods sold
Product costs attributable to the units sold.

deduct cost of goods sold

gross margin percentage
Gross profit divided by sales revenue, expressed as a percentage.

calculate gross margin percentage

promotional uplift
An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison.

measure promotional uplift

incremental revenue
Additional revenue relative to the defined comparison.

estimate incremental revenue

contribution margin
Revenue less the variable costs included in its definition.

define contribution margin

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

selling price SELLING PRICE

set the selling price

Keep the meaning precise: The amount charged per unit before specified adjustments.

gross margin percentage GROSS MARGIN PERCENTAGE

calculate gross margin percentage

Keep the meaning precise: Gross profit divided by sales revenue, expressed as a percentage.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

price elasticity

The responsiveness of quantity demanded to price changes.

estimate price elasticity

halo effect

A related benefit beyond the promoted product itself.

test for a halo effect

average order value

Revenue divided by the relevant order count.

monitor average order value

redemption rate

The proportion using an offer among a defined eligible base.

calculate redemption rate

funding allowance

A contribution toward promotion costs under agreed terms.

verify a funding allowance

break-even volume

Units required to meet a specified cost or profit threshold.

calculate break-even volume

cannibalization

Sales gained by one offer at another offer's expense.

assess cannibalization

basket value

The monetary value of a customer's purchase basket.

increase basket value

discount depth

The size of a price reduction against its reference.

compare discount depth

promotion mechanic

The structure by which an offer operates.

explain the promotion mechanic

price override

An authorized change from the system's listed selling price.

approve a price override

margin dilution

A reduction in the relevant profit margin.

quantify margin dilution

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

contribution margin CONTRIBUTION MARGIN

define contribution margin

Keep the meaning precise: Revenue less the variable costs included in its definition.

average order value AVERAGE ORDER VALUE

monitor average order value

Keep the meaning precise: Revenue divided by the relevant order count.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge volume
The promotion sold twenty percent more units.

State the new price
The promotional price was $42.50.

Calculate revenue
One hundred twenty times $42.50 gives $5,100.

Show the unit effect
Unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to $12.50.

Define the margin
Gross margin percentage uses revenue as its denominator.

Recognize another objective
New-customer acquisition would need a separate measure.

Limit the conclusion
These figures do not establish net profitability.

Protect the baseline
Use the same product and comparable periods.

Correct the inference
That does not by itself establish higher profit.

Keep the cost basis
Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit.

Separate the measures
Revenue rose two percent; gross profit fell twenty-five percent.

Name the exclusion
This calculation excludes operating and promotional expenses.

Avoid a false shortcut
The price and volume changes must be multiplied.

Ask about funding
Has any supplier allowance actually been agreed?

Explain the threshold
At $12.50 per unit, 160 units would match the prior gross profit.

Close the review
Let us report the volume gain and the margin cost together.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Keep the cost basis
Useful wording: Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit.

Purpose: Calculate revenue
Useful wording: One hundred twenty times $42.50 gives $5,100.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

A. Revenue rose 20%.
B. Revenue fell 15%.
C. Revenue rose 2%.
D. Revenue rose 5%.

2. What happened to gross profit?

A. It increased to $5,100.
B. It stayed at $2,000.
C. It increased 20% with units.
D. It fell from $2,000 to $1,500.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Product costs attributable to the units sold. Which term fits?

A. cost of goods sold
B. baseline
C. halo effect
D. funding allowance

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The unit volume improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.

B. Yes. That gives gross profit of two thousand dollars before and fifteen hundred during the promotion. On that measure, the result fell twenty-five percent despite the higher revenue.

C. Because cost of goods sold also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.

D. Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this baseline comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.

Answers and explanations, page 112

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Units rose 20%, while price fell 15%. Revenue changes multiplicatively: 1.20 times 0.85 equals 1.02, a 2% increase. Subtracting the two percentages would incorrectly give 5%.

E Conversation

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

baseline / unit volume / cost of goods sold / break-even volume / unit gross profit / gross profit / funding allowance / gross margin percentage / Sales revenue / margin dilution

01 **Hugo:** Units were up twenty percent. I have called that a profit improvement in the trading note. Can you check the wording before I send it?

02 **Nia:** The [1] _____ improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.

03 **Hugo:** That gives five thousand one hundred dollars, compared with five thousand in the normal week.

04 **Nia:** Correct. [2] _____ increased two percent. We multiply the quantity and price factors, rather than subtracting fifteen percent from twenty percent and calling the difference five.

05 **Hugo:** Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?

06 **Nia:** Because [3] _____ also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.

07 **Hugo:** So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week.

08 **Nia:** Yes. That gives [4] _____ of two thousand dollars before and fifteen hundred during the promotion. On that measure, the result fell twenty-five percent despite the higher revenue.

09 **Hugo:** We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs.

10 **Nia:** The [5] _____ fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Hugo:** We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold.

12 **Nia:** Right. This [6] _____ is defined as matching the prior gross profit, not covering every business expense. The definition needs to stay next to the number.

13 **Hugo:** Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?

14 **Nia:** Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this [7] _____ comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.

15 **Hugo:** The buyer mentioned possible supplier funding. Do we have an agreed amount, or should I leave it out of this result?

16 **Nia:** Only if the [8] _____ is confirmed and accounted for on the correct basis. At present, these figures contain no agreed supplier contribution. Keep that possibility separate.

17 **Hugo:** What percentage should the margin line show?

18 **Nia:** The [9] _____ is approximately twenty-nine point four percent, down from forty. That is a revenue-based ratio, not the twenty-five-percent change in gross profit dollars.

19 **Hugo:** I will report the volume gain and the lower gross profit, then list customer acquisition as an unanswered question.

20 **Nia:** Good. Describe the [10] _____ clearly without declaring every campaign objective a failure. We can assess the wider decision when the additional evidence is available.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. unit volume / **2.** Sales revenue / **3.** cost of goods sold / **4.** gross profit / **5.** unit gross profit / **6.** break-even volume / **7.** baseline / **8.** funding allowance / **9.** gross margin percentage / **10.** margin dilution

Why these answers fit, page 113

F Check accuracy and scope

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

Return to the case

In the baseline week, a product sold 100 units at $50 each. During the promotion it sold 120 units at $42.50 each, a 15% price reduction. Product cost remained $30 per unit. These are complete comparable weekly sales with no returns. Taxes, shipping income, operating expenses, and other promotional costs are excluded. Trading manager Hugo says the 20% unit increase proves that profit improved. Finance partner Nia must correct that claim and separate the measured result from other possible campaign objectives.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

A. 100
B. 120
C. 150
D. 160

2. Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

A. Product cost remained $30 per unit.
B. Promotion revenue was $5,100.
C. Gross profit fell on the stated basis.
D. The campaign acquired profitable new customers.

Answers and explanations, page 114

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the profit-matching threshold from actual sales.

Keep the success criterion explicit

A promotional team may emphasize traffic or new customers while finance emphasizes margin. Name the objective being tested. Correcting the arithmetic does not require calling the entire campaign a failure; other benefits need their own evidence.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Calculate another promotion result

A product sells 50 units at $80 in the baseline period and 60 units at $70 in the promotion. Product cost is $50 per unit. Exclude all other costs and returns.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

4,000 / 1,500 / 1,200 / 4,200

01 **Manager:** Baseline revenue was [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Analyst:** Promotion revenue was [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Manager:** Baseline gross profit was [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Analyst:** Promotion gross profit was [4] _____ dollars.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 4,000 / **2.** 4,200 / **3.** 1,500 / **4.** 1,200

Why these answers fit, page 115

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "The buyer mentioned possible supplier funding. Do we have an agreed amount, or should I leave it out of this result?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. That gives gross profit of two thousand dollars before and fifteen hundred during the promotion. On that measure, the result fell twenty-five percent despite the higher revenue.

B. Because cost of goods sold also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.

C. Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this baseline comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.

D. The unit volume improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.

Answers and explanations, page 116

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Merchandising and Assortment Planning" and "Pricing, Promotions, and Margin". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant. Which term fits?

A. core line
B. weeks of cover
C. stock-keeping unit (SKU)
D. full-price sale

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison. Which term fits?

A. selling price
B. price elasticity
C. redemption rate
D. promotional uplift

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "Some sizes may be carrying the leftovers. We should see whether the original distribution matched what customers actually selected." Cal: [missing response] Inez: "I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I would not recommend an immediate delisting. First, separate B by size and colorway. An aggregate result can hide strong variants alongside weak ones.
B. Then review the size curve. That may support changing quantities within the range rather than removing every option. We need the variant-level data before deciding.
C. Agreed, but B also leaves more residual stock. We have eighty units remaining there, compared with twenty in A. Those units still need a commercial plan.
D. I will add gross margin return on inventory once we have the required cost and average-stock information. I will not manufacture it from these sales totals.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "What percentage should the margin line show?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "I will report the volume gain and the lower gross profit, then list customer acquisition as an unanswered question." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Sales revenue increased two percent. We multiply the quantity and price factors, rather than subtracting fifteen percent from twenty percent and calling the difference five.

B. The unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.

C. The gross margin percentage is approximately twenty-nine point four percent, down from forty. That is a revenue-based ratio, not the twenty-five-percent change in gross profit dollars.

D. Right. This break-even volume is defined as matching the prior gross profit, not covering every business expense. The definition needs to stay next to the number.

Answers and explanations, page 147

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / INVENTORY, ALLOCATION, AND REPLENISHMENT

Translate inventory states into an accurate location-specific availability message.

> **The national total cannot promise store pickup**
>
> At 09:00, SKU L42 has 100 units physically on hand at the central warehouse: 60 committed to existing orders, ten held for quality review, and 30 available for new sales. Twenty additional units are incoming and are not included in on-hand stock. Store East has no units. The website incorrectly uses the warehouse total to display pickup availability at Store East. Inventory controller Miro and digital trader Anika must correct the promise and check delivery eligibility before offering a warehouse fulfillment route.

People: Miro, Inventory controller; Anika, Digital trader.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

A. 30
B. 100
C. 60
D. 120

2. How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

A. 20
B. 30
C. 100
D. None

3. What is established for Store East?

A. Its replenishment has already arrived.
B. It has no units.
C. It has all 100 warehouse units.
D. It can offer immediate pickup of 30 units.

Answers and explanations, page 117

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

on-hand inventory
Stock physically held at the stated location.

reconcile on-hand inventory

available inventory
Stock eligible for new sales under the stated rules.

confirm available inventory

committed inventory
Stock already allocated to existing demand.

protect committed inventory

unavailable inventory
Held stock not currently eligible for sale.

classify unavailable inventory

incoming inventory
Stock expected but not yet received into the location.

track incoming inventory

quality hold
A restriction pending the applicable product-quality review.

maintain a quality hold

allocation
Assignment of stock to a demand source or destination.

revise the allocation

replenishment
Restocking to support future sales or demand.

schedule replenishment

available to promise
Quantity that can be committed under defined fulfillment rules.

calculate available to promise

stockout
Lack of the required sellable stock at a location.

report a store stockout

location-level availability
Sellable stock information for a particular site.

verify location-level availability

inventory feed
Data supplied to another system about stock quantities or states.

correct the inventory feed

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

on-hand inventory ON-HAND INVENTORY

reconcile on-hand inventory

Keep the meaning precise: Stock physically held at the stated location.

quality hold QUALITY HOLD

maintain a quality hold

Keep the meaning precise: A restriction pending the applicable product-quality review.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

safety stock
Stock held as a buffer against uncertainty.
review safety stock

reorder point
The stock position that triggers replenishment under a policy.
set a reorder point

lead time
Elapsed time between defined order and supply milestones.
verify replenishment lead time

transfer order
A record authorizing movement between inventory locations.
create a transfer order

cycle count
A targeted physical count of selected inventory.
perform a cycle count

inventory adjustment
A recorded change to the system's stock quantity.
authorize an inventory adjustment

overselling
Accepting demand beyond what can be fulfilled as promised.
prevent overselling

backorder
Unfilled demand awaiting stock under the applicable arrangement.
manage a backorder

fulfillment eligibility
Whether an item and location may serve a specified order.
check fulfillment eligibility

stock reservation
Holding specified stock for a defined demand.
confirm a stock reservation

inventory snapshot
Quantities and states captured at a particular time.
timestamp the inventory snapshot

channel allocation
Assignment of inventory to particular sales channels.
review channel allocation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

inventory feed INVENTORY FEED

correct the inventory feed

Keep the meaning precise: Data supplied to another system about stock quantities or states.

cycle count CYCLE COUNT

perform a cycle count

Keep the meaning precise: A targeted physical count of selected inventory.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Identify the item
We are checking SKU L42.

Separate physical and sellable stock
One hundred units are on hand, but only thirty are available.

Respect the hold
Ten units remain under quality review.

State the local position
Store East currently has no units.

Check the route
Can this warehouse fulfill this customer's delivery address?

Request a fresh check
Refresh the quantity before making the offer.

Keep the hold intact
Do not release held units just to cover the website promise.

Coordinate the correction
Update the customer-facing message and the underlying feed.

Timestamp the quantity
This is the inventory position at 09:00.

Protect existing orders
Sixty units are already committed.

Keep incoming stock separate
Twenty units are incoming, not yet received.

Correct the promise
The warehouse total must not drive a ready-for-pickup message here.

Avoid an assumed reservation
Availability alone does not mean this order has reserved stock.

Name the system issue
The feed is using the wrong location and inventory state.

Limit a transfer claim
A proposed transfer is not a received replenishment.

Close with a verified option
Offer a delivery route only after eligibility is confirmed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Protect existing orders
Useful wording: Sixty units are already committed.

Purpose: Respect the hold
Useful wording: Ten units remain under quality review.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which website claim is supported now?

A. Held stock is available whenever demand is high.

B. Store East has no stock for pickup.

C. One hundred units are ready at Store East.

D. All incoming units are ready for immediate sale.

2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

A. 100 minus 10 equals 90 available.

B. 100 minus 60 equals 40 available.

C. 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.

D. 100 plus 20 equals 120 available.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Held stock not currently eligible for sale. Which term fits?

A. fulfillment eligibility

B. unavailable inventory

C. available to promise

D. lead time

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The national total cannot promise store pickup". Anika: "We also have twenty on the way. Someone added them to the website quantity." Miro: [missing response] Anika: "Could we use the ten held units until the next shipment arrives?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Review the inventory feed. It needs the correct location and state, not just a national physical total. Otherwise the visible correction will be overwritten by the next update.

B. No. That is on-hand inventory. Sixty are committed to existing orders, and ten are held for quality review. Only thirty remain available for new sales.

C. First check fulfillment eligibility. Available stock does not prove that this warehouse serves the customer's address or that the order meets the route's conditions.

D. Keep incoming inventory separate. Those twenty have not been received. Adding them to current sellable stock would create a promise we cannot support from this snapshot.

Answers and explanations, page 117

> **One useful distinction**
>
> On hand is not the same as available. Here the 100 warehouse units comprise 60 committed, ten held, and 30 available. The 20 incoming units are additional expected stock, not stock already received.

E Conversation

The national total cannot promise store pickup

The national total cannot promise store pickup

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

inventory snapshot / fulfillment eligibility / location-level availability / quality hold / on-hand inventory / transfer order / inventory feed / committed inventory / stock reservation / incoming inventory

01 **Anika:** East is getting pickup requests for L42, but the manager says the shelf is empty. The page shows one hundred units. Can we trace where that number came from?

02 **Miro:** Start with the [1] _____ at nine this morning. The hundred units belong to the central warehouse, not Store East. The page is drawing the wrong conclusion from that total.

03 **Anika:** Even at the warehouse, can we sell all one hundred to new customers?

04 **Miro:** No. That is [2] _____. Sixty are committed to existing orders, and ten are held for quality review. Only thirty remain available for new sales.

05 **Anika:** We also have twenty on the way. Someone added them to the website quantity.

06 **Miro:** Keep [3] _____ separate. Those twenty have not been received. Adding them to current sellable stock would create a promise we cannot support from this snapshot.

07 **Anika:** Could we use the ten held units until the next shipment arrives?

08 **Miro:** The [4] _____ remains in place. We cannot release them merely because the page overpromised. The correction must respect the actual stock states rather than make them fit the message.

09 **Anika:** And the sixty already assigned cannot be offered a second time.

10 **Miro:** Correct. Protect [5] _____. We should not solve one customer promise by quietly taking stock from another order. The available balance here is thirty, not ninety or one hundred.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The national total cannot promise store pickup

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Anika:** I will remove the Store East pickup claim. Could we offer delivery from the warehouse instead?

12 **Miro:** First check [6] _____. Available stock does not prove that this warehouse serves the customer's address or that the order meets the route's conditions.

13 **Anika:** If delivery is possible, can I say we have put one aside? I have not created a reservation yet.

14 **Miro:** Only after the actual [7] _____ is confirmed. Other orders may arrive after our snapshot. Refresh the quantity before offering a specific commitment.

15 **Anika:** That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages.

16 **Miro:** Review the [8] _____. It needs the correct location and state, not just a national physical total. Otherwise the visible correction will be overwritten by the next update.

17 **Anika:** The store manager has asked for a warehouse transfer. Can we mark the store replenished?

18 **Miro:** Not yet. A [9] _____ is different from receipt. Check approval and timing, then update the store position when the relevant events actually occur.

19 **Anika:** I will show no pickup stock at East, check the warehouse delivery route, and raise the feed correction.

20 **Miro:** Good. Keep [10] _____ visible in the handoff. That gives stores, digital trading, and customer service one accurate basis for the next conversation.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. inventory snapshot / **2.** on-hand inventory / **3.** incoming inventory / **4.** quality hold / **5.** committed inventory / **6.** fulfillment eligibility / **7.** stock reservation / **8.** inventory feed / **9.** transfer order / **10.** location-level availability

Why these answers fit, page 118

F Check accuracy and scope

The national total cannot promise store pickup

Return to the case

At 09:00, SKU L42 has 100 units physically on hand at the central warehouse: 60 committed to existing orders, ten held for quality review, and 30 available for new sales. Twenty additional units are incoming and are not included in on-hand stock. Store East has no units. The website incorrectly uses the warehouse total to display pickup availability at Store East. Inventory controller Miro and digital trader Anika must correct the promise and check delivery eligibility before offering a warehouse fulfillment route.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which step requires a separate check?

A. Whether twenty units are incoming
B. Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route
C. Whether Store East currently has zero units
D. Whether ten units are held

2. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

A. A transfer needs the actual timing confirmed.
B. The replenishment has arrived at Store East.
C. We can review a transfer option.
D. Store East has no units at this snapshot.

Answers and explanations, page 120

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; check delivery eligibility before offering warehouse stock.

Ask which stock number the team means

Merchandising, stores, and digital teams may all say available while referring to different records. Repeat the location and status instead of assuming agreement. This makes a correction collaborative and prevents a national total from becoming an unsupported local promise.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Read a second inventory snapshot

At Warehouse North, 80 units are on hand: 45 committed, five held, and the rest available. Twelve more are incoming. Store South has zero units.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

zero / twelve / 30 / five

01 **Trader:** The available warehouse quantity is [1] _____.

02 **Controller:** The held quantity is [2] _____.

03 **Trader:** The incoming quantity is [3] _____.

04 **Controller:** Store South's current quantity is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 30 / **2.** five / **3.** twelve / **4.** zero

Why these answers fit, page 120

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The national total cannot promise store pickup". Anika: "If delivery is possible, can I say we have put one aside? I have not created a reservation yet." Miro: [missing response] Anika: "That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Not yet. A transfer order is different from receipt. Check approval and timing, then update the store position when the relevant events actually occur.

B. Good. Keep location-level availability visible in the handoff. That gives stores, digital trading, and customer service one accurate basis for the next conversation.

C. First check fulfillment eligibility. Available stock does not prove that this warehouse serves the customer's address or that the order meets the route's conditions.

D. Only after the actual stock reservation is confirmed. Other orders may arrive after our snapshot. Refresh the quantity before offering a specific commitment.

Answers and explanations, page 121

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / FULFILLMENT, SHIPPING, AND RETURNS

Acknowledge a missed delivery estimate, distinguish shipment from arrival, and explain a concrete follow-up.

> **An expired estimate needs an honest next step**
>
> Order R81 was physically handed to the carrier on 4 May. The customer was given an estimated arrival date of 6 May. It is now 7 May, and the carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time. Customer Laila needs the item for an event. Agent Tomas can open a carrier inquiry and give a status update at 14:00 today. No replacement dispatch, refund, or revised arrival is authorized in the supplied record. The team must check applicable customer rights and service remedies rather than invent a universal rule.

People: Laila, Customer; Tomas, Customer service agent.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is confirmed?

A. The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.
B. The order arrived on 6 May.
C. A replacement has shipped.
D. A refund is approved.

2. What does 14:00 today represent?

A. A replacement dispatch time
B. An automatic refund deadline
C. A status update
D. Guaranteed delivery

3. What is unknown?

A. The order reference
B. The original estimated date
C. The date of carrier handoff
D. The revised arrival time

Answers and explanations, page 122

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

fulfillment
The process of preparing and completing an order's supply.

track order fulfillment

dispatch
Sending goods from the seller's fulfillment operation.

confirm dispatch

carrier handoff
Physical transfer of a parcel to the transport provider.

verify carrier handoff

estimated delivery date
A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee.

revise an estimated delivery date

tracking event
A recorded milestone in a shipment's movement.

check the latest tracking event

carrier inquiry
A request for the transport provider to investigate a shipment.

open a carrier inquiry

proof of delivery
A record supporting that delivery occurred.

request proof of delivery

delivery exception
An event interrupting the expected delivery process.

investigate a delivery exception

last mile
The final transport stage to the recipient.

coordinate last-mile delivery

delivery window
A stated interval during which arrival is expected or scheduled.

confirm the delivery window

service level
The defined standard or terms of a delivery service.

verify the service level

consignment
Goods sent together under a transport arrangement.

identify the consignment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

fulfillment FULFILLMENT

track order fulfillment

Keep the meaning precise: The process of preparing and completing an order's supply.

carrier inquiry CARRIER INQUIRY

open a carrier inquiry

Keep the meaning precise: A request for the transport provider to investigate a shipment.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

tracking number
An identifier used to follow a shipment.
provide the tracking number

partial fulfillment
Supply of only part of an order.
record partial fulfillment

return to sender
Routing a parcel back to the sending party.
investigate return to sender

refund authorization
Approval to return the relevant payment.
confirm refund authorization

return authorization
Permission or reference for a return under a process.
issue a return authorization

return inspection
Examination of returned goods under the applicable process.
complete a return inspection

split shipment
An order sent in separate deliveries.
explain a split shipment

delivery attempt
An effort to deliver at the specified address.
verify a delivery attempt

replacement order
An order created to supply a substitute for an earlier item.
authorize a replacement order

service recovery
Actions addressing a failure in the customer experience.
coordinate service recovery

reverse logistics
Movement and handling of goods back from customers.
manage reverse logistics

restocking fee
A charge associated with a return where applicable and lawful.
explain a restocking fee

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

consignment CONSIGNMENT
identify the consignment
Keep the meaning precise: Goods sent together under a transport arrangement.

return to sender RETURN TO SENDER
investigate return to sender
Keep the meaning precise: Routing a parcel back to the sending party.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the missed estimate

The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order.

Recognize the impact

I understand that you need the item for an event.

State the verified milestone

The carrier physically received the parcel on 4 May.

Avoid an unsupported date

I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time.

Take the next action

I can open an inquiry with the carrier now.

Own the follow-up

I will update you today at 14:00.

Separate contact and arrival

That is the update time, not a delivery guarantee.

Check the latest event

I will confirm what the tracking record actually shows.

Avoid blame

I will remain your contact while we investigate.

Limit the remedy claim

No replacement has been authorized in this record.

Check available options

I will review the applicable service remedies and customer rights.

Confirm before promising

I need confirmation before giving a new arrival window.

Avoid false certainty

The absence of a new scan does not prove the parcel is lost.

Keep the order reference

I will record the inquiry against R81.

Provide an honest update

I will contact you even if the carrier has not answered.

Close with accountability

The next message will state the latest position and outstanding action.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid an unsupported date
Useful wording: I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time.

Purpose: Take the next action
Useful wording: I can open an inquiry with the carrier now.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which response is both honest and useful?

A. The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.
B. It will certainly arrive by 14:00.
C. The carrier has it, so the seller has no further role.
D. No scan proves it is permanently lost.

2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

A. Creating a label
B. An expected arrival on 6 May
C. Promising an update on 7 May
D. Physical carrier handoff on 4 May

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee. Which term fits?

A. partial fulfillment
B. return authorization
C. last mile
D. estimated delivery date

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?" Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I mean I will contact you. The latest tracking event may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

B. I cannot confirm a new delivery window yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.

C. I am sorry the estimated delivery date has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.

D. I will check that rather than invent a refund authorization. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.

Answers and explanations, page 122

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A shipping label alone does not prove carrier possession. This case does establish physical handoff. Shipment on 4 May still does not establish delivery on 6 May or any revised arrival time.

E Conversation

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

carrier inquiry / delivery exception / refund authorization / delivery window / dispatch / replacement order / carrier handoff / service recovery / tracking event / estimated delivery date

01 **Laila:** My order was due yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking has stopped changing. Can you tell me whether the carrier actually has it?

02 **Tomas:** I am sorry the [1] _____ has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.

03 **Laila:** Does the record show that you sent it, or only that someone printed a label?

04 **Tomas:** It confirms [2] _____ on the fourth of May. That is stronger than a label-created message, but it does not tell us when the parcel will reach your address.

05 **Laila:** The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?

06 **Tomas:** I cannot confirm a new [3] _____ yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.

07 **Laila:** What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website.

08 **Tomas:** I can open a [4] _____ and remain your contact. I will ask for the current location and the latest delivery position, then update you today at fourteen hundred.

09 **Laila:** Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?

10 **Tomas:** I mean I will contact you. The latest [5] _____ may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

Conversation continues on the next page.

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Laila:** Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?

12 **Tomas:** A [6] _____ has not been authorized. I can review the available remedies under the actual order and service terms, including any applicable customer rights, before confirming an option.

13 **Laila:** I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need.

14 **Tomas:** I will check that rather than invent a [7] _____. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.

15 **Laila:** The missing scans worry me. Does that mean the parcel is lost?

16 **Tomas:** Not by itself. A [8] _____ or a delayed update needs investigation. I do not have evidence that establishes loss, and I will not label the shipment delivered without support either.

17 **Laila:** Please still call at two if you have not heard back. I need time to arrange something else for the event.

18 **Tomas:** I will. The [9] _____ note will include your concern, the inquiry, and the outstanding answer. You should not have to start the explanation again with another agent.

19 **Laila:** Thank you. I need a clear position so I can decide what to do about the event.

20 **Tomas:** Understood. We will keep the verified [10] _____ information separate from arrival and remedy decisions. My next contact is today at two, with the actual position even if some questions remain open.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. estimated delivery date / **2.** carrier handoff / **3.** delivery window / **4.** carrier inquiry / **5.** tracking event / **6.** replacement order / **7.** refund authorization / **8.** delivery exception / **9.** service recovery / **10.** dispatch

Why these answers fit, page 123

F Check accuracy and scope

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

Return to the case

Order R81 was physically handed to the carrier on 4 May. The customer was given an estimated arrival date of 6 May. It is now 7 May, and the carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time. Customer Laila needs the item for an event. Agent Tomas can open a carrier inquiry and give a status update at 14:00 today. No replacement dispatch, refund, or revised arrival is authorized in the supplied record. The team must check applicable customer rights and service remedies rather than invent a universal rule.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which promise is not supported?

A. A replacement will arrive tomorrow.
B. An inquiry can be opened.
C. An update will be given today.
D. The revised arrival is unconfirmed.

2. What should a pending-carrier update do?

A. Invent a new date to sound decisive.
B. Say the customer has no rights because the date was estimated.
C. Avoid contacting the customer until delivery occurs.
D. State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.

Answers and explanations, page 125

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; offer a review of real remedies without guessing the outcome.

Own the communication without inventing control

Customers need an accountable seller contact even when a carrier holds the parcel. Avoid blaming another company or offering vague reassurance. State the verified event, the unanswered question, and a follow-up you can actually deliver.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Give a second delayed-order update

Order V32 was handed to the carrier on 12 June. Its estimated arrival was 14 June. Today is 15 June. A new arrival time is unconfirmed; the agent will update the customer at 16:00.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / 14 June / 16:00 / 12 June

01 **Agent:** Carrier handoff occurred on [1] _____.

02 **Customer:** The original estimated arrival was [2] _____.

03 **Agent:** The revised arrival time remains [3] _____.

04 **Customer:** The next status update is at [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 12 June / **2.** 14 June / **3.** unconfirmed / **4.** 16:00

Why these answers fit, page 125

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need." Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "The missing scans worry me. Does that mean the parcel is lost?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I mean I will contact you. The latest tracking event may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

B. I will check that rather than invent a refund authorization. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.

C. I am sorry the estimated delivery date has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.

D. I cannot confirm a new delivery window yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.

Answers and explanations, page 126

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment" and "Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Stock already allocated to existing demand. Which term fits?

A. backorder
B. replenishment
C. reorder point
D. committed inventory

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An event interrupting the expected delivery process. Which term fits?

A. tracking number
B. refund authorization
C. delivery exception
D. fulfillment

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs." Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Sales revenue increased two percent. We multiply the quantity and price factors, rather than subtracting fifteen percent from twenty percent and calling the difference five.
B. The unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.
C. The unit volume improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.
D. Only if the funding allowance is confirmed and accounted for on the correct basis. At present, these figures contain no agreed supplier contribution. Keep that possibility separate.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "Please still call at two if you have not heard back. I need time to arrange something else for the event." Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "Thank you. I need a clear position so I can decide what to do about the event." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will. The service recovery note will include your concern, the inquiry, and the outstanding answer. You should not have to start the explanation again with another agent.

B. A replacement order has not been authorized. I can review the available remedies under the actual order and service terms, including any applicable customer rights, before confirming an option.

C. It confirms carrier handoff on the fourth of May. That is stronger than a label-created message, but it does not tell us when the parcel will reach your address.

D. I can open a carrier inquiry and remain your contact. I will ask for the current location and the latest delivery position, then update you today at fourteen hundred.

Answers and explanations, page 149

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / CONVERSION, UX, AND DIGITAL ANALYTICS

Report a conversion change accurately and distinguish an observed association from a causal claim.

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

Before a checkout redesign, 400 of 1,000 eligible checkout sessions completed a purchase. Afterward, 320 of 1,000 did so. For this report, checkout conversion is completed purchasing sessions divided by eligible checkout sessions; one session counts at most once. A payment-provider outage also occurred in the later period. Event collection and traffic mix have not yet been verified as comparable. Product lead Mara and analyst Dev must explain the decline without claiming that the redesign alone caused it.

People: Mara, Digital product lead; Dev, Commerce analyst.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is the later conversion rate?

A. 40%
B. 8%
C. 20%
D. 32%

2. What is the absolute rate decline?

A. Eight percent relative
B. Twenty percentage points
C. Thirty-two percentage points
D. Eight percentage points

3. Which causal conclusion is established?

A. The redesign alone caused the decline.
B. The outage explains every lost purchase.
C. The decline proves there was no measurement issue.
D. The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.

Answers and explanations, page 127

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

checkout conversion
Completed purchasing sessions divided by the specified checkout-session base.

measure checkout conversion

checkout abandonment
Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout.

investigate checkout abandonment

purchase event
A recorded event representing a purchase action.

validate the purchase event

duplicate event
An event recorded more than once for the same action.

remove duplicate events

denominator
The base quantity used in a rate calculation.

keep the denominator consistent

relative change
A change expressed as a proportion of its initial value.

calculate relative change

conversion funnel
The ordered steps toward a defined customer action.

examine the conversion funnel

eligible session
A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria.

define eligible sessions

event instrumentation
The implementation of event collection in a digital product.

audit event instrumentation

deduplication
Identifying and handling repeated records of the same event.

validate deduplication

percentage point
One unit of difference between percentage rates.

report a percentage-point change

traffic mix
The composition of visitors by relevant source or characteristic.

compare traffic mix

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

checkout conversion CHECKOUT CONVERSION

measure checkout conversion

Keep the meaning precise: Completed purchasing sessions divided by the specified checkout-session base.

event instrumentation EVENT INSTRUMENTATION

audit event instrumentation

Keep the meaning precise: The implementation of event collection in a digital product.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

device segment
A group of users or sessions using a specified device type.
analyze a device segment

payment gateway
A service connecting a checkout to payment processing.
monitor the payment gateway

confounder
A factor that complicates a causal interpretation.
identify a confounder

controlled experiment
A comparison designed to isolate an intervention's effect.
run a controlled experiment

cohort
A group sharing a defined characteristic or starting event.
define a cohort

friction
An obstacle making a customer action harder.
reduce checkout friction

payment failure
An unsuccessful payment attempt under the relevant process.
investigate payment failures

provider outage
A disruption to a third-party service.
isolate the provider outage

causal attribution
Assigning an observed outcome to its cause.
qualify causal attribution

random assignment
Allocation by chance to comparison groups.
verify random assignment

user experience (UX)
A person's experience of interacting with a product or service.
assess the user experience

rollback
Returning a change to an earlier version.
evaluate a rollback

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

traffic mix TRAFFIC MIX

compare traffic mix

Keep the meaning precise: The composition of visitors by relevant source or characteristic.

confounder CONFOUNDER

identify a confounder

Keep the meaning precise: A factor that complicates a causal interpretation.

C Phrases that move the work forward

State the observed result

Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent.

Give the relative comparison

Relative to the original rate, the decline is twenty percent.

Protect the denominator

Both periods contain one thousand eligible checkout sessions.

Limit causality

This comparison does not isolate the redesign's effect.

Separate events and sessions

More purchase events do not necessarily mean more purchasing sessions.

Investigate the outage

Separate affected and unaffected time intervals.

Recognize the business problem

Uncertain attribution does not make the decline unimportant.

Keep a decision conditional

A rollback decision should use the full risk and performance evidence.

Use the correct absolute unit

That is a decline of eight percentage points.

Define the counted outcome

We count a session once if it completes a purchase.

Name the competing event

A payment-provider outage overlapped the later period.

Request a measurement check

Has event collection remained consistent across the release?

Check composition

Compare traffic and device mix before interpreting the aggregate.

Avoid a new overclaim

That breakdown would be informative, not automatically causal.

Define a next analysis

Validate the data, then compare the relevant segments.

Summarize the finding

We have a measured decline and an unresolved explanation.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Define the counted outcome
Useful wording: We count a session once if it completes a purchase.

Purpose: Protect the denominator
Useful wording: Both periods contain one thousand eligible checkout sessions.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

A. Conversion fell eight percent relative and twenty percentage points.
B. Conversion fell thirty-two percentage points.
C. Conversion rose because session counts were unchanged.
D. Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.

2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

A. Purchased items
B. All recorded purchase events
C. Only sessions that purchased
D. Eligible checkout sessions

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria. Which term fits?

A. eligible session
B. payment gateway
C. cohort
D. denominator

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A checkout decline with two competing explanations". Mara: "Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?" Dev: [missing response] Mara: "The payment provider was down during part of the later period. That seems important." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The checkout conversion rate did fall, from forty to thirty-two percent. We should acknowledge that result, but the before-and-after chart alone does not identify the cause.

B. Use eight percentage points for the absolute change. The relative decline is twenty percent because we divide the eight-point difference by the original forty-percent rate.

C. No. A common denominator count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.

D. Not necessarily. Check deduplication and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.

Answers and explanations, page 127

One useful distinction

The conversion rate fell from 40% to 32%: eight percentage points, or a 20% relative decline from the original rate. These are two descriptions of the same change, not interchangeable units.

E Conversation

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

checkout conversion / traffic mix / rollback / denominator / provider outage / percentage points / event instrumentation / deduplication / causal attribution / device segment

01 **Mara:** Checkout is down after the redesign. The release team wants a rollback recommendation this morning. What can we actually conclude from this chart?

02 **Dev:** The [1] _____ rate did fall, from forty to thirty-two percent. We should acknowledge that result, but the before-and-after chart alone does not identify the cause.

03 **Mara:** I wrote an eight-percent decline in my draft. Is that the clearest description?

04 **Dev:** Use eight [2] _____ for the absolute change. The relative decline is twenty percent because we divide the eight-point difference by the original forty-percent rate.

05 **Mara:** Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?

06 **Dev:** No. A common [3] _____ count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.

07 **Mara:** The payment provider was down during part of the later period. That seems important.

08 **Dev:** The [4] _____ is a competing explanation we must investigate. We cannot ignore it, but we also cannot assume it accounts for every missing purchase.

09 **Mara:** Can we compare the affected hours with the unaffected hours?

10 **Dev:** Yes, while checking [5] _____. Those intervals may attract different visitors. The breakdown can identify patterns, but it is not automatically a controlled estimate of the redesign's effect.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mara:** The developers changed some analytics code during the release. Could that affect the result?

12 **Dev:** We should audit [6] _____. Confirm that checkout entry and completion are captured consistently. Otherwise an apparent behavior change may include a measurement change.

13 **Mara:** The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?

14 **Dev:** Not necessarily. Check [7] _____ and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.

15 **Mara:** So the same session could produce several recorded events without becoming several successful sessions.

16 **Dev:** Exactly. Then examine each relevant [8] _____. A mobile-specific issue would be useful to locate, but we should not invent one before seeing the breakdown.

17 **Mara:** We still need to make a release decision. Which checks can we finish first, and what would remain uncertain afterward?

18 **Dev:** Agreed. Evaluate a [9] _____ alongside the actual risks and diagnostics. My caution concerns the explanation, not whether the decline deserves urgent attention.

19 **Mara:** I will report the two rates, the outage, and the checks we are doing before claiming a cause.

20 **Dev:** That keeps [10] _____ honest. We have a real reported decline, several testable questions, and a clear next analysis. That is more useful than blaming the release from one chart.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. checkout conversion / **2.** percentage points / **3.** denominator / **4.** provider outage / **5.** traffic mix / **6.** event instrumentation / **7.** deduplication / **8.** device segment / **9.** rollback / **10.** causal attribution

Why these answers fit, page 128

F Check accuracy and scope

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

Return to the case

Before a checkout redesign, 400 of 1,000 eligible checkout sessions completed a purchase. Afterward, 320 of 1,000 did so. For this report, checkout conversion is completed purchasing sessions divided by eligible checkout sessions; one session counts at most once. A payment-provider outage also occurred in the later period. Event collection and traffic mix have not yet been verified as comparable. Product lead Mara and analyst Dev must explain the decline without claiming that the redesign alone caused it.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement overclaims causality?

A. The redesign caused the entire decline.

B. The decline coincided with a provider outage.

C. Measurement consistency needs checking.

D. The later rate was thirty-two percent.

2. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

A. Count duplicate events as separate successful sessions.

B. Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.

C. Assume all missing purchases were outage-related.

D. Ignore device mix because totals match.

Answers and explanations, page 130

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; separate purchasing sessions from purchase events.

Make a challenge testable

A design review can become personal when an unfavorable metric is treated as a verdict on the team. State the measured change, identify competing explanations, and request checks that can distinguish them. Avoid using uncertainty to dismiss a real decline.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Explain a second conversion comparison

A fixed report counts 300 purchasing sessions out of 600 eligible sessions before a change and 240 out of 600 afterward. One session counts at most once.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

50% / ten percentage points / 40% / 20%

01 **Lead:** The original rate was [1] _____.

02 **Analyst:** The later rate was [2] _____.

03 **Lead:** The absolute decline was [3] _____.

04 **Analyst:** The relative decline was [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 50% / **2.** 40% / **3.** ten percentage points / **4.** 20%

Why these answers fit, page 130

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A checkout decline with two competing explanations". Mara: "The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?" Dev: [missing response] Mara: "So the same session could produce several recorded events without becoming several successful sessions." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Not necessarily. Check deduplication and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.

B. The checkout conversion rate did fall, from forty to thirty-two percent. We should acknowledge that result, but the before-and-after chart alone does not identify the cause.

C. No. A common denominator count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.

D. Use eight percentage points for the absolute change. The relative decline is twenty percent because we divide the eight-point difference by the original forty-percent rate.

Answers and explanations, page 131

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / MARKETPLACE AND VENDOR MANAGEMENT

Challenge a vendor scorecard by specifying the unit, denominator, period, and comparison limits.

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

A July scorecard shows Vendor K with ten defective units and Vendor M with five. The heading says K has the higher defect rate. Receiving records show 800 units received from K and 200 from M in July. Count each defective unit once, even if it has several faults; all counts refer to these July receipts. Product mix and inspection intensity have not been confirmed as comparable. Vendor manager Rosa and supplier representative Malik must correct the rate comparison before discussing causes or commercial deductions.

People: Rosa, Vendor manager; Malik, Supplier representative.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

A. 10%
B. 5%
C. 2.5%
D. 1.25%

2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

A. 5%
B. 0.625%
C. 2.5%
D. 1.25%

3. What remains unverified?

A. K's July received count
B. M's July defective-unit count
C. The stated counting rule
D. Comparable product mix and inspection intensity

Answers and explanations, page 132

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

vendor scorecard
A report comparing supplier performance against defined measures.

correct a vendor scorecard

defect count
The number of individual faults identified.

distinguish the defect count

inspection intensity
The extent or frequency of examination.

compare inspection intensity

reporting period
The time interval covered by a measure.

specify the reporting period

vendor allowance
A supplier-funded amount under agreed commercial terms.

verify a vendor allowance

supplier corrective action
An action addressing an established supplier-related problem.

request supplier corrective action

defective-unit rate
Defective units divided by the specified unit population.

calculate the defective-unit rate

received units
Units recorded as received within the defined scope.

confirm received units

product mix
The composition of products within a measured group.

control for product mix

purchase order
A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms.

reconcile the purchase order

chargeback
A commercial deduction or charge asserted under applicable terms.

dispute a vendor chargeback

root cause
The underlying reason for a problem, supported by investigation.

establish the root cause

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

vendor scorecard VENDOR SCORECARD

correct a vendor scorecard

Keep the meaning precise: A report comparing supplier performance against defined measures.

product mix PRODUCT MIX

control for product mix

Keep the meaning precise: The composition of products within a measured group.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

acceptance criterion

A requirement used to determine whether goods meet expectations.

confirm the acceptance criterion

inspection record

Evidence of what was examined and found.

retrieve the inspection record

sample size

The number of units examined in a sample.

state the sample size

lot

A defined group of goods identified for traceability.

trace the affected lot

return to vendor

Sending goods back to the supplying party.

authorize a return to vendor

marketplace listing

A product offer displayed on a marketplace.

update the marketplace listing

seller of record

The party identified as the seller for the transaction.

identify the seller of record

catalog attribute

A structured product detail such as size or material.

correct a catalog attribute

content compliance

Conformity with applicable product-content requirements.

review content compliance

service-level agreement

Terms defining expected service performance and responsibilities.

review the service-level agreement

dispute evidence

Records supporting a challenge to a claim or deduction.

submit dispute evidence

remediation plan

A defined set of actions to address a problem.

agree a remediation plan

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

root cause ROOT CAUSE

establish the root cause

Keep the meaning precise: The underlying reason for a problem, supported by investigation.

return to vendor RETURN TO VENDOR

authorize a return to vendor

Keep the meaning precise: Sending goods back to the supplying party.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Ask for the base

What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?

Clarify the counted object

Count each defective unit once, not every fault separately.

Show the calculation

Ten divided by eight hundred gives 1.25%.

Keep defects visible

Correcting the ranking does not remove the ten defective units.

Request traceable evidence

Please link the findings to the relevant lots and inspection records.

Separate commercial authority

A scorecard result does not automatically authorize a deduction.

Keep the challenge constructive

I am challenging the rate label, not dismissing the reported defects.

Define the follow-up

Review the defect evidence and the comparison basis separately.

State the period

Both figures refer to July receipts.

Correct the label

Ten is a count, not a percentage.

Compare accurately

K has the larger count but the lower observed rate.

Check comparability

Were product mix and inspection intensity comparable?

Avoid an unsupported cause

These numbers do not establish how the damage occurred.

Check the terms

We need the applicable agreement before deciding any chargeback.

Agree a correction

Let us republish the rates with their denominators.

Close the dispute precisely

The arithmetic is corrected; the cause and commercial outcome remain open.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Correct the label
Useful wording: Ten is a count, not a percentage.

Purpose: Show the calculation
Useful wording: Ten divided by eight hundred gives 1.25%.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

A. K has a higher rate because ten exceeds five.

B. Both rates are equal because both have defects.

C. M's rate is five percent regardless of receipts.

D. K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.

2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

A. As three received units

B. As no defective units

C. As one defective unit

D. As three defective units

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Units recorded as received within the defined scope. Which term fits?

A. sample size

B. vendor allowance

C. received units

D. content compliance

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "They all relate to July. Some units had several faults; the inspection team counted each affected unit once." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Any chargeback needs the applicable terms and evidence. Correcting the rate does not decide that question, and the original heading does not automatically establish a right to deduct.

B. Please also state the reporting period. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.

C. Could we check the received units behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.

D. Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed root cause. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.

Answers and explanations, page 132

One useful distinction

A count is not a rate. K has more defective units but a lower defective-unit rate: 10/800 = 1.25%, compared with M at 5/200 = 2.5%. Each defective unit is counted only once.

E Conversation

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

reporting period / vendor scorecard / defect count / root cause / remediation plan / chargeback / product mix / defective-unit rate / inspection record / received units

01 **Rosa:** Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?

02 **Malik:** Could we check the [1] _____ behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.

03 **Rosa:** The receiving file has eight hundred units from K and two hundred from M.

04 **Malik:** Then our [2] _____ is one point two five percent, while M's is two point five percent. The larger defect count does not make our rate higher.

05 **Rosa:** You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review.

06 **Malik:** Please also state the [3] _____. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.

07 **Rosa:** They all relate to July. Some units had several faults; the inspection team counted each affected unit once.

08 **Malik:** Good. That distinguishes defective units from [4] _____. We should preserve that rule in the scorecard so next month's calculation does not silently change.

09 **Rosa:** Does the lower rate mean K has better quality overall?

10 **Malik:** It is a lower observed rate, but we need to compare [5] _____ and inspection intensity before making that broader claim. I would not use the corrected arithmetic to dismiss the ten units.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Rosa:** The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined.

12 **Malik:** Please share the relevant [6] _____ through the agreed channel. We can review the lot references and acceptance criteria rather than argue over an unexplained total.

13 **Rosa:** Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that.

14 **Malik:** Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed [7] _____. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.

15 **Rosa:** Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?

16 **Malik:** Any [8] _____ needs the applicable terms and evidence. Correcting the rate does not decide that question, and the original heading does not automatically establish a right to deduct.

17 **Rosa:** I will separate the metric correction from the quality investigation and the commercial discussion.

18 **Malik:** That works. We can agree a [9] _____ when the findings support the actions. Let us not promise a packaging change merely to close the meeting.

19 **Rosa:** I will republish both denominators, the July period, and the corrected percentages. The ten affected units will remain visible.

20 **Malik:** Thank you. The revised [10] _____ will then support a fair discussion. We can acknowledge the quality concern while keeping the arithmetic, causal investigation, and contract issues distinct.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. received units / **2.** defective-unit rate / **3.** reporting period / **4.** defect count / **5.** product mix / **6.** inspection record / **7.** root cause / **8.** chargeback / **9.** remediation plan / **10.** vendor scorecard

Why these answers fit, page 133

F Check accuracy and scope

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

Return to the case

A July scorecard shows Vendor K with ten defective units and Vendor M with five. The heading says K has the higher defect rate. Receiving records show 800 units received from K and 200 from M in July. Count each defective unit once, even if it has several faults; all counts refer to these July receipts. Product mix and inspection intensity have not been confirmed as comparable. Vendor manager Rosa and supplier representative Malik must correct the rate comparison before discussing causes or commercial deductions.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which claim still needs investigation?

A. K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.
B. K received 800 units in July.
C. M had five defective units.
D. K's observed rate is 1.25%.

2. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

A. Requesting inspection records
B. Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice
C. Correcting the rate arithmetic
D. Stating the received-unit counts

Answers and explanations, page 135

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish a corrected metric from a supported chargeback.

Make the disputed number reproducible

Supplier discussions can become adversarial when a scorecard is treated as unquestionable. Ask for the counted unit and denominator, then do the calculation together. Correcting a ranking does not excuse the underlying defects or establish which party caused them.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Correct a second supplier ranking

For the same month, Vendor P has six defective units among 600 received; Vendor Q has four among 200. Count each defective unit once.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

1% / P / Q / 2%

01 **Manager:** P's defective-unit rate is [1] _____.

02 **Supplier:** Q's defective-unit rate is [2] _____.

03 **Manager:** The larger defective-unit count belongs to [3] _____.

04 **Supplier:** The higher defective-unit rate belongs to [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 1% / **2.** 2% / **3.** P / **4.** Q

Why these answers fit, page 135

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Please also state the reporting period. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.

B. Any chargeback needs the applicable terms and evidence. Correcting the rate does not decide that question, and the original heading does not automatically establish a right to deduct.

C. Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed root cause. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.

D. Could we check the received units behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics" and "Marketplace and Vendor Management". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout. Which term fits?

A. payment failure
B. checkout abandonment
C. deduplication
D. random assignment

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms. Which term fits?

A. vendor scorecard
B. seller of record
C. acceptance criterion
D. purchase order

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?" Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I am sorry the estimated delivery date has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.
B. I mean I will contact you. The latest tracking event may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.
C. I will check that rather than invent a refund authorization. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.
D. I cannot confirm a new delivery window yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "I will separate the metric correction from the quality investigation and the commercial discussion." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "I will republish both denominators, the July period, and the corrected percentages. The ten affected units will remain visible." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Could we check the received units behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.

B. Please share the relevant inspection record through the agreed channel. We can review the lot references and acceptance criteria rather than argue over an unexplained total.

C. Then our defective-unit rate is one point two five percent, while M's is two point five percent. The larger defect count does not make our rate higher.

D. That works. We can agree a remediation plan when the findings support the actions. Let us not promise a packaging change merely to close the meeting.

Answers and explanations, page 151

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / CUSTOMER SERVICE AND ESCALATIONS

Acknowledge a customer request, explain a bounded exception review, and distinguish policy from applicable rights.

> **A return request beyond the goodwill window**
>
> Customer Owen wants to return an unworn $80 jacket because he changed his mind. His request is on day 35; the retailer states a 30-day change-of-mind return window for this purchase. No fault or misdescription is alleged. Agent Elena cannot approve a goodwill exception but can submit a review to the store manager. No review outcome is supplied. Before treating the policy as decisive, the team must check any applicable customer rights and transaction facts. A fault complaint would require a different assessment, not an automatic rejection under the goodwill window.

People: Owen, Customer; Elena, Service representative.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

A. A recall notice requires its return.
B. He changed his mind.
C. The jacket is alleged to be faulty.
D. The wrong product was delivered.

2. What can Elena authorize herself?

A. A guaranteed exchange
B. A binding extension of every return window
C. Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception
D. An immediate $80 refund

3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

A. As a universal legal limit for every transaction
B. As irrelevant to any review
C. As proof the jacket is defective
D. As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights

Answers and explanations, page 137

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

change-of-mind return
A return requested because the customer no longer wants the item.

handle a change-of-mind return

goodwill exception
A discretionary departure from policy where permitted.

request a goodwill exception

proof of purchase
Evidence identifying a purchase and its relevant details.

verify proof of purchase

item condition
The physical state of a product.

assess item condition

store credit
Value available for a future purchase from the retailer.

explain store credit

refund
Return of an amount paid.

confirm a refund

return window
The period specified for a return under particular terms.

check the return window

exception authority
The defined power to approve a policy departure.

confirm exception authority

purchase channel
The route through which the customer bought the item.

identify the purchase channel

original payment method
The payment route used for the original purchase.

verify the original payment method

exchange
Replacing a purchased item with another under relevant terms.

authorize an exchange

manager review
Assessment by the person assigned the relevant decision authority.

submit a manager review

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

change-of-mind return CHANGE-OF-MIND RETURN

handle a change-of-mind return

Keep the meaning precise: A return requested because the customer no longer wants the item.

purchase channel PURCHASE CHANNEL

identify the purchase channel

Keep the meaning precise: The route through which the customer bought the item.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

fault allegation

A customer's statement that a product has a defect.

record a fault allegation

misdescription

A mismatch between an item and its stated description.

investigate misdescription

applicable rights

Customer protections relevant to the actual transaction.

check applicable rights

statutory remedy

A remedy arising under the relevant law.

distinguish a statutory remedy

policy discretion

Permitted choice within an organization's policy authority.

explain policy discretion

escalation route

The defined path to a higher or specialist review.

offer an escalation route

complaint record

A documented account of a customer's concern and its handling.

maintain a complaint record

case owner

The person responsible for coordinating the case.

identify the case owner

review outcome

The result of an assessment.

communicate the review outcome

reason code

A structured label describing the basis for a transaction or request.

select the correct reason code

resolution option

A possible way to address the customer's concern.

verify resolution options

service handoff

Transfer of relevant context and responsibility to another team member.

complete a service handoff

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

manager review MANAGER REVIEW

submit a manager review

Keep the meaning precise: Assessment by the person assigned the relevant decision authority.

policy discretion POLICY DISCRETION

explain policy discretion

Keep the meaning precise: Permitted choice within an organization's policy authority.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the request

You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind.

Identify the timing

This request is on day thirty-five.

State the policy carefully

The stated change-of-mind window for this purchase is thirty days.

Keep rights separate

We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction.

Explain your authority

I can submit the request, but I cannot approve an exception myself.

Offer the real next step

I can refer this to the store manager for review.

Avoid a guaranteed outcome

Submission does not guarantee a refund or exchange.

Request relevant evidence

Please provide the purchase details through our approved process.

Respect the customer's choice

Would you like me to submit that review?

Record the correct reason

I will record this as a change-of-mind request.

Distinguish a new allegation

If you are reporting a fault, I need to record and assess that separately.

Avoid an invented substitute

Store credit has not been approved either.

Reduce repetition

I will include the details you have already supplied.

Name the decision-maker

The manager holds the stated exception authority.

Keep the handoff useful

The record will show the timing, reason, item condition, and requested remedy.

Close honestly

I will communicate the actual review outcome without promising it in advance.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Keep rights separate
Useful wording: We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction.

Purpose: Explain your authority
Useful wording: I can submit the request, but I cannot approve an exception myself.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

A. I have extended the policy for every customer.

B. I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.

C. I can guarantee the manager will approve this.

D. Store credit is automatically yours because a refund is unavailable.

2. Which record best matches the stated request?

A. Misdescription established; exchange mandatory

B. Customer withdrew the request

C. Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; $80 purchase

D. Confirmed product defect; refund approved

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The defined power to approve a policy departure. Which term fits?

A. store credit

B. exception authority

C. review outcome

D. applicable rights

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A return request beyond the goodwill window". Owen: "I am not saying there is anything wrong with it. I simply chose the wrong style for myself." Elena: [missing response] Owen: "If you send it to the manager, does that mean I will get the money back?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will preserve that in the service handoff. The next response should communicate the actual assessment and explain the available next step, not make you reconstruct this conversation.

B. I will record that accurately. I can request a goodwill exception, but I cannot approve one myself. The store manager can assess the request under the relevant process.

C. A fault allegation would need to be recorded and assessed separately under the applicable rights and facts. I cannot decide that hypothetical claim from the change-of-mind policy alone.

D. The complaint record will show the eighty-dollar jacket, unworn condition, day thirty-five, and your preference. It will not say a refund or exchange has already been agreed.

Answers and explanations, page 137

> **One useful distinction**
>
> This is a change-of-mind request on day 35, not an established fault claim. Record the actual reason accurately. The 30-day policy is a fictional retailer rule for this purchase, not a universal statement of consumer law.

E Conversation

A return request beyond the goodwill window

A return request beyond the goodwill window

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

proof of purchase / exception authority / manager review / store credit / service handoff / goodwill exception / complaint record / fault allegation / change-of-mind return / return window

01 **Owen:** I paid eighty dollars for this jacket and have not worn it. I chose the wrong style. I am five days outside the return window; is a review possible?

02 **Elena:** You are asking for a [1] _____ on day thirty-five. I understand you would prefer not to keep an unworn item. Let me explain what I can do without promising a decision I cannot make.

03 **Owen:** The receipt says thirty days. Is there any way to ask someone to look at it?

04 **Elena:** Yes. The stated [2] _____ is thirty days for this purchase. We also need to check the actual transaction and applicable rights rather than treat that policy as a universal legal answer.

05 **Owen:** I am not saying there is anything wrong with it. I simply chose the wrong style for myself.

06 **Elena:** I will record that accurately. I can request a [3] _____, but I cannot approve one myself. The store manager can assess the request under the relevant process.

07 **Owen:** If you send it to the manager, does that mean I will get the money back?

08 **Elena:** No. A [4] _____ is a request for a decision, not the decision itself. I do not want you to hear a refund promise when I am offering a review.

09 **Owen:** Would store credit be easier? I would be willing to buy something else here.

10 **Elena:** I can include that preference, but [5] _____ has not been approved either. I should not present it as an automatic substitute simply because the original request is outside the stated window.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A return request beyond the goodwill window

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Owen:** All right. What information does the manager need from me?

12 **Elena:** We need the relevant [6] _____, the item condition, and your requested remedy through the approved process. I will include what you have already told me so you do not have to start again.

13 **Owen:** I have the receipt and the jacket with its tags. Please submit the request.

14 **Elena:** I will. The manager has the [7] _____ described in our process. I will keep your reason and preferred outcomes clear rather than suggest the jacket is faulty to make the request sound stronger.

15 **Owen:** Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?

16 **Elena:** A [8] _____ would need to be recorded and assessed separately under the applicable rights and facts. I cannot decide that hypothetical claim from the change-of-mind policy alone.

17 **Owen:** That is clear. For now, it is just the style, and I would like the review.

18 **Elena:** The [9] _____ will show the eighty-dollar jacket, unworn condition, day thirty-five, and your preference. It will not say a refund or exchange has already been agreed.

19 **Owen:** Please include the receipt details in the handoff. I would rather not start again when the manager responds.

20 **Elena:** I will preserve that in the [10] _____. The next response should communicate the actual assessment and explain the available next step, not make you reconstruct this conversation.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. change-of-mind return / **2.** return window / **3.** goodwill exception / **4.** manager review / **5.** store credit / **6.** proof of purchase / **7.** exception authority / **8.** fault allegation / **9.** complaint record / **10.** service handoff

Why these answers fit, page 138

F Check accuracy and scope

A return request beyond the goodwill window

Return to the case

Customer Owen wants to return an unworn $80 jacket because he changed his mind. His request is on day 35; the retailer states a 30-day change-of-mind return window for this purchase. No fault or misdescription is alleged. Agent Elena cannot approve a goodwill exception but can submit a review to the store manager. No review outcome is supplied. Before treating the policy as decisive, the team must check any applicable customer rights and transaction facts. A fault complaint would require a different assessment, not an automatic rejection under the goodwill window.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

A. Promise a refund before checking any facts.
B. Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.
C. Reject it automatically because the goodwill window ended.
D. Change the label to avoid an investigation.

2. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

A. The manager has accepted the request.
B. Your exception is guaranteed.
C. Would you like me to submit the review?
D. Your refund is being processed.

Answers and explanations, page 140

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep a change-of-mind request distinct from a fault report.

Empathy is not an approval formula

An apologetic tone can accidentally sound like a refund commitment. Acknowledge the inconvenience, then state exactly what can happen next. Avoid describing a customer as difficult merely because the requested remedy is outside your authority.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Keep another review within its authority

A customer requests a change-of-mind return on day 22 under a stated 14-day policy. Agent Noor may submit a review to manager Beth but cannot approve it. No outcome is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

approval / Beth / 22 / 14

01 **Noor:** The request is on day [1] _____.

02 **Customer:** The stated policy window is [2] _____ days.

03 **Noor:** The manager reviewing the request is [3] _____.

04 **Customer:** Submission does not guarantee [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 22 / **2.** 14 / **3.** Beth / **4.** approval

Why these answers fit, page 140

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A return request beyond the goodwill window". Owen: "I have the receipt and the jacket with its tags. Please submit the request." Elena: [missing response] Owen: "Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We need the relevant proof of purchase, the item condition, and your requested remedy through the approved process. I will include what you have already told me so you do not have to start again.

B. You are asking for a change-of-mind return on day thirty-five. I understand you would prefer not to keep an unworn item. Let me explain what I can do without promising a decision I cannot make.

C. I will. The manager has the exception authority described in our process. I will keep your reason and preferred outcomes clear rather than suggest the jacket is faulty to make the request sound stronger.

D. Yes. The stated return window is thirty days for this purchase. We also need to check the actual transaction and applicable rights rather than treat that policy as a universal legal answer.

Answers and explanations, page 141

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / STORE OPERATIONS AND OMNICHANNEL EXECUTION

Give an actionable shift handoff that corrects a false pickup status without hiding the missing item.

> **Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf**
>
> At 16:00, pickup order P64 shows ready online. It contains three items: a notebook, a pen set, and a mug. Staff have located and staged the notebook and pen set, but cannot find the mug. No substitute has been approved. Outgoing lead Talia must hand the issue to incoming lead Evan, who will contact the customer and update the case at 16:30. The local process requires every ordered item to be verified and staged before the whole order is marked ready. Partial pickup needs the permitted process and the customer's agreement.

People: Talia, Outgoing shift lead; Evan, Incoming shift lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which item has not been located?

A. The mug
B. The notebook
C. The pen set
D. All three items

2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

A. A shift handoff completed
B. Every ordered item verified and staged
C. Any one item scanned
D. A label printed

3. Who owns the next customer contact?

A. The customer
B. Evan
C. Talia after she leaves
D. An unnamed carrier

Answers and explanations, page 142

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

omnichannel
Coordinated retail activity across store and digital channels.

coordinate omnichannel execution

click and collect
An online order collected from a designated location.

manage click-and-collect orders

point of sale (POS)
The system or place where a retail sale is processed.

reconcile POS records

pick list
A list of items and quantities to retrieve.

verify the pick list

pickup shelf
The area holding orders prepared for collection.

check the pickup shelf

short pick
A pick in which the required quantity cannot be found or supplied.

record a short pick

buy online, pick up in store (BOPIS)
Ordering online for collection at a store.

fulfill a BOPIS order

order management system (OMS)
Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status.

update the OMS

picking
Retrieving the specified items for an order.

complete order picking

staging
Placing picked items in the designated holding area.

confirm order staging

ready-for-pickup status
A status indicating the specified readiness conditions are met.

correct ready-for-pickup status

item-level status
The state recorded for an individual order item.

update item-level status

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

omnichannel OMNICHANNEL

coordinate omnichannel execution

Keep the meaning precise: Coordinated retail activity across store and digital channels.

picking PICKING

complete order picking

Keep the meaning precise: Retrieving the specified items for an order.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

order-level status

The overall state recorded for the complete order.

correct order-level status

customer consent

The customer's agreement to a proposed action.

obtain customer consent

pickup notification

A message telling the customer about collection readiness.

correct a pickup notification

cancellation line

An order item recorded for cancellation under the process.

confirm a cancellation line

shift handoff

Transfer of work status and responsibility between shifts.

give a shift handoff

discrepancy log

A record of mismatches requiring follow-up.

update the discrepancy log

substitution

Supplying a different item in place of the ordered one.

confirm a substitution

partial pickup

Collection of only part of the ordered items.

arrange partial pickup

collection verification

Checking the required identity or order details at pickup.

complete collection verification

refund status

The actual stage of returning the relevant payment.

verify refund status

action owner

The person responsible for a specified next action.

name the action owner

resolution checkpoint

A scheduled point to review progress on an open issue.

set a resolution checkpoint

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

item-level status ITEM-LEVEL STATUS

update item-level status

Keep the meaning precise: The state recorded for an individual order item.

pickup notification PICKUP NOTIFICATION

correct a pickup notification

Keep the meaning precise: A message telling the customer about collection readiness.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Start with the order

This handoff concerns pickup order P64.

Name the gap

The mug has not been found.

Apply the local rule

Whole-order readiness requires all three items to be verified and staged.

Protect the remaining items

Keep the two staged items identified with this order.

Offer a bounded choice

Check whether partial pickup is permitted and whether the customer agrees.

Set the checkpoint

Update the case at 16:30.

Keep money status separate

Do not mark a refund complete unless it has actually reached that status.

Preserve the open item

The mug remains unresolved until its actual disposition is recorded.

State the verified items

The notebook and pen set are located and staged.

Identify the contradiction

The website says ready, but the order is incomplete.

Correct the visible status

We need to correct the ready message through the approved process.

Reject an assumed substitute

No substitute has been approved.

Assign the next action

Evan will contact the customer.

Limit the promise

That is a review time, not a promise that the mug will be found.

Reduce repeated work

Record which locations have already been checked.

Close the handoff

Confirm the owner, customer message, and outstanding item before leaving.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Identify the contradiction
Useful wording: The website says ready, but the order is incomplete.

Purpose: Apply the local rule
Useful wording: Whole-order readiness requires all three items to be verified and staged.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handoff is actionable?

A. P64 is sorted; the next shift can check later.

B. All items are ready because the website says so.

C. The mug must have been collected because it is absent.

D. P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.

2. Which substitution claim is supported?

A. The pen set replaces the mug automatically.

B. Silence from the customer confirms a substitution.

C. No substitute has been approved.

D. Any similar mug may be supplied without agreement.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status. Which term fits?

A. pickup shelf

B. order management system (OMS)

C. customer consent

D. shift handoff

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey." Evan: [missing response] Talia: "Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Keep refund status separate from the request. We must not tell the customer money has been returned before that is supported by the relevant record.

B. I will address the pickup notification and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.

C. Keep that staging information in the handoff. We should protect those items while we investigate the mug, not return them to general stock without a proper reason.

D. Good. Record the short pick against the mug and preserve the actual item details. Do not infer theft, collection, or cancellation simply because we cannot find it.

Answers and explanations, page 142

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Two staged items do not make this three-item order ready under the stated local process. A missing mug is not evidence that it was collected, canceled, or refunded. Keep each status tied to its actual event.

E Conversation

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

resolution checkpoint / action owner / substitution / discrepancy log / order-level status / pickup notification / staging / refund status / short pick / partial pickup

01 **Talia:** Can I hand over P64 before I leave? It says ready online, but I can only account for the notebook and pen set on the pickup shelf.

02 **Evan:** Then the [1] _____ does not match the physical position. Which item is missing, and have we confirmed the other two belong to this order?

03 **Talia:** The mug has not been found. The notebook and pen set are identified for P64 and are already in the designated holding area.

04 **Evan:** Keep that [2] _____ information in the handoff. We should protect those items while we investigate the mug, not return them to general stock without a proper reason.

05 **Talia:** The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey.

06 **Evan:** I will address the [3] _____ and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.

07 **Talia:** Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?

08 **Evan:** We can check whether [4] _____ is permitted and ask whether that works for them. We should not assume they want two trips or silently treat the missing line as complete.

09 **Talia:** There is another mug on display, but it is not the one ordered. Please check with the customer before offering it as a substitute.

10 **Evan:** Then there is no approved [5] _____. Similar appearance is not enough. The customer may have chosen the specific size or design for a reason.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Talia:** I will list the locations already checked so your team does not repeat the same search.

12 **Evan:** Good. Record the [6] _____ against the mug and preserve the actual item details. Do not infer theft, collection, or cancellation simply because we cannot find it.

13 **Talia:** You will own the customer contact after the shift change. Shall we set a review at half past four?

14 **Evan:** Yes. I am the [7] _____, and I will update the case at sixteen thirty. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising the mug will be found by then.

15 **Talia:** If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process.

16 **Evan:** Correct. Keep [8] _____ separate from the request. We must not tell the customer money has been returned before that is supported by the relevant record.

17 **Talia:** I will leave P64 open with two staged items, the missing mug, the incorrect ready message, and the search history.

18 **Evan:** Add those points to the [9] _____. I will correct the customer-facing position through the approved process and make the offered options explicit when we speak.

19 **Talia:** That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update.

20 **Evan:** Confirmed. The [10] _____ is sixteen thirty, and the mug remains unresolved. I will carry the customer contact and record the actual next decision instead of allowing the ready label to stand.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. order-level status / **2.** staging / **3.** pickup notification / **4.** partial pickup / **5.** substitution / **6.** short pick / **7.** action owner / **8.** refund status / **9.** discrepancy log / **10.** resolution checkpoint

Why these answers fit, page 143

F Check accuracy and scope

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

Return to the case

At 16:00, pickup order P64 shows ready online. It contains three items: a notebook, a pen set, and a mug. Staff have located and staged the notebook and pen set, but cannot find the mug. No substitute has been approved. Outgoing lead Talia must hand the issue to incoming lead Evan, who will contact the customer and update the case at 16:30. The local process requires every ordered item to be verified and staged before the whole order is marked ready. Partial pickup needs the permitted process and the customer's agreement.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does 16:30 mean?

A. Automatic cancellation of the whole order
B. A case-update checkpoint
C. Guaranteed completion of the missing-item search
D. A confirmed refund completion time

2. Which record would invent an event?

A. Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it
B. Keeping the mug unresolved
C. Recording the two staged items
D. Correcting the unsupported ready message

Answers and explanations, page 145

Listen for the distinction

Swap roles for turns 11-20; confirm the contact owner and update time.

Handover language must support the next action

A cheerful all sorted can conceal an unfinished customer problem. Name the item, the physical status, the system discrepancy, and the next owner. The incoming colleague needs enough detail to act without repeating the search or misleading the customer.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Give a second pickup handoff

Order C17 contains four items. Three are staged; a desk lamp is missing. Incoming lead Jun owns the next customer contact and will update the case at 18:00. No substitute is approved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Jun / desk lamp / C17 / 18:00

01 **Outgoing lead:** The order reference is [1] _____.

02 **Jun:** The missing item is the [2] _____.

03 **Outgoing lead:** The next contact owner is [3] _____.

04 **Jun:** The next case update is at [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. C17 / **2.** desk lamp / **3.** Jun / **4.** 18:00

Why these answers fit, page 145

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "You will own the customer contact after the shift change. Shall we set a review at half past four?" Evan: [missing response] Talia: "If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will address the pickup notification and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.

B. Yes. I am the action owner, and I will update the case at sixteen thirty. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising the mug will be found by then.

C. We can check whether partial pickup is permitted and ask whether that works for them. We should not assume they want two trips or silently treat the missing line as complete.

D. Confirmed. The resolution checkpoint is sixteen thirty, and the mug remains unresolved. I will carry the customer contact and record the actual next decision instead of allowing the ready label to stand.

Answers and explanations, page 146

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Customer Service and Escalations" and "Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A discretionary departure from policy where permitted. Which term fits?

A. goodwill exception
B. misdescription
C. case owner
D. original payment method

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Placing picked items in the designated holding area. Which term fits?

A. cancellation line
B. omnichannel
C. order-level status
D. staging

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "Does the lower rate mean K has better quality overall?" Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. It is a lower observed rate, but we need to compare product mix and inspection intensity before making that broader claim. I would not use the corrected arithmetic to dismiss the ten units.
B. Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed root cause. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.
C. Could we check the received units behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.
D. Please also state the reporting period. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "I will leave P64 open with two staged items, the missing mug, the incorrect ready message, and the search history." Evan: [missing response] Talia: "That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Keep that staging information in the handoff. We should protect those items while we investigate the mug, not return them to general stock without a proper reason.

B. Add those points to the discrepancy log. I will correct the customer-facing position through the approved process and make the offered options explicit when we speak.

C. Correct. Keep refund status separate from the request. We must not tell the customer money has been returned before that is supported by the relevant record.

D. Then the order-level status does not match the physical position. Which item is missing, and have we confirmed the other two belong to this order?

Answers and explanations, page 153

Language for the next case

Sales are not the bank payout

settlement statement

The settlement statement connects the captured sales to refunds, fees, reserved funds, and the issued payout; the difference is not automatically missing money.

Felix: Let us follow the settlement statement. Four hundred went back to customers, three hundred is fees, and two hundred has been reserved.

processing fees

The processing fees are the stated $300 deduction; unlike the reserve, they are nonrefundable under this fictional statement's terms.

Felix: That is sales less the supplied refunds, before the other statement adjustments. The processing fees reduce the amount available for payout by another three hundred.

reserve hold

The reserve hold sets aside $200 rather than paying it out now; it is distinct from the nonrefundable $300 fee and has no supplied release date.

Felix: No. The reserve hold is money set aside under these terms. It is not the same as a nonrefundable charge.

bank receipt

Bank receipt confirms the funds actually reached the bank; an issued marketplace payout is a different processing stage and is not sufficient evidence of receipt.

Felix: Check the bank receipt first. The bank has not confirmed it in our supplied record, so keep the transfer outstanding for reconciliation.

reserve release

A reserve release makes previously held funds available; it does not create a new customer sale, and any later deductions still need reconciliation.

Felix: No. A reserve release concerns existing funds. We would reconcile the later statement and its actual deductions rather than record a new sale.

reconciliation trail

A reconciliation trail preserves how each adjustment connects the source statement to the payout and bank record, making later differences traceable.

Felix: That gives us a usable reconciliation trail. Finance can then apply the appropriate accounting treatment without trying to reconstruct the statement from one net figure.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Sales are not the bank payout

Fictional marketplace statement: $5,000 captured item sales, $400 refunds, $300 nonrefundable fees, and $200 newly reserved. No opening balance, tax, shipping, currency conversion, or other adjustments. The resulting payout has been issued but is not yet confirmed received by the bank. The reserve release date is unspecified.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

settlement statement / bank receipt / reserve hold / reserve release / reconciliation trail / processing fees

01 **Nora:** The marketplace shows five thousand in sales, but the payout is only four thousand one hundred. Have we lost nine hundred dollars somewhere?

02 **Felix:** Let us follow the [1] _____. Four hundred went back to customers, three hundred is fees, and two hundred has been reserved.

03 **Nora:** After the refunds, that leaves four thousand six hundred. I had treated that as the amount we should see in the bank.

04 **Felix:** That is sales less the supplied refunds, before the other statement adjustments. The [2] _____ reduce the amount available for payout by another three hundred.

05 **Nora:** So we are at four thousand three hundred before the reserve. Is the reserved two hundred another fee?

06 **Felix:** No. The [3] _____ is money set aside under these terms. It is not the same as a nonrefundable charge.

Conversation / continued

07 **Nora:** Then the reconciliation is five thousand, less four hundred, less three hundred, less two hundred: four thousand one hundred issued.

08 **Felix:** Exactly. Keep the four lines visible. If we label the entire nine-hundred difference as marketplace commission, both the refund and reserve explanations disappear.

09 **Nora:** The dashboard says the payout has been issued. Can I mark it received in our cash report now?

10 **Felix:** Check the [4] _____ first. The bank has not confirmed it in our supplied record, so keep the transfer outstanding for reconciliation.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Sales are not the bank payout

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Nora:** I will match the payout reference against the bank entry when it appears. An equal amount alone might not identify the right transfer.

12 **Felix:** Good. Retain the reference, amount, currency, and dates. Also make sure the refund rows belong to this settlement rather than subtracting them a second time elsewhere.

13 **Nora:** If the two hundred is released next month, should the sales report show another two hundred of sales?

14 **Felix:** No. A [5] _____ concerns existing funds. We would reconcile the later statement and its actual deductions rather than record a new sale.

15 **Nora:** Can I put the release in next month's cash forecast as certain? I would like to use that money for a supplier payment.

16 **Felix:** We have no release date here. Show any forecast assumption explicitly and check the applicable reserve terms before making a commitment against it.

17 **Nora:** I will keep captured sales, refunds, fees, and held funds in separate columns. The payout column will remain separate from confirmed bank receipts.

18 **Felix:** That gives us a usable [6] _____. Finance can then apply the appropriate accounting treatment without trying to reconstruct the statement from one net figure.

19 **Nora:** For today's trading call: four thousand one hundred issued, two hundred reserved, and bank receipt still outstanding. Not nine hundred in unexplained losses.

20 **Felix:** That is clear. Attach the statement reference and leave the receipt check assigned to me; the commercial team can use the sales measures without confusing them with cash.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. settlement statement / **2.** processing fees / **3.** reserve hold / **4.** bank receipt / **5.** reserve release / **6.** reconciliation trail

Why these answers fit, page 155

Trace a smaller payout

Fictional statement: $2,000 captured sales, $150 refunds, $100 fees, and $80 reserved. No other adjustments. The payout is issued, but bank receipt is unconfirmed. Any later reserve release relates to these existing funds.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

1,850 / 1,670 / unconfirmed / sale

01 **Manager:** Sales less the refunds equal [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Analyst:** After fees and the reserve, the issued payout is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Manager:** Bank receipt is still [3] _____.

04 **Analyst:** Releasing the reserve would not create a new [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 1,850 / **2.** 1,670 / **3.** unconfirmed / **4.** sale

Why these answers fit, page 155

Keep the distinction audible

Reconcile marketplace receipts, refunds, fees, and reserved funds without calling every difference a loss.

Language for the next case

The right shirt, the wrong variant

variant SKU

The variant SKU identifies the specific internal item: HT-BL-L is blue/large, while HT-BL-M is blue/medium with no available units.

Sana: The twenty belongs to large. The variant SKU ends in L, and the size field says large. The title has been copied from medium.

item group ID

The item group ID groups genuine variants of the same product; it does not replace each variant's distinct identifier or merge their stock quantities.

Sana: No. The shared item group ID connects variants of the same shirt. Keep distinct item IDs and the correct size on each row.

size attribute

The size attribute must describe the offered variant; here large is correct and medium in the title is the mismatch needing correction.

Sana: Exactly. The size attribute is already correct for large. Fix the misleading title rather than changing that accurate field to match it.

landing-page selection

The landing-page selection must correspond to the advertised variant; a large listing linked to a preselected medium option still creates a mismatch.

Sana: We need the landing-page selection to match the large offer. Test the actual feed link, not just navigation from the main product page.

GTIN

The Global Trade Item Number is a product identifier assigned under the applicable system; the verified large-variant GTIN must not be replaced with medium's merely to make grouped rows match.

Sana: No. Preserve the verified GTIN. Sharing a product group does not make different trade-item identifiers interchangeable. Do not invent a replacement number either.

processed feed

The processed feed shows what the destination accepted after ingestion; saving the source file alone does not establish the final displayed offer.

Sana: Not yet. Check the processed feed and the displayed offer after ingestion. Record any delay or rejection instead of assuming the update has propagated.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

The right shirt, the wrong variant

Fictional Harbor Tee variants: blue/medium SKU HT-BL-M has zero available; blue/large SKU HT-BL-L has twenty. Both belong to group HARBOR-TEE. The large variant's shopping-feed title incorrectly says medium and its link preselects medium. Its size field and manufacturer-assigned GTIN are verified as large. No customer order has been placed.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

item group ID / GTIN / landing-page selection / size attribute / processed feed / variant SKU

01 **Joel:** The shopping result says blue, medium, twenty available. Our medium shelf is empty. Is this another inventory-feed problem?

02 **Sana:** The twenty belongs to large. The [1] _____ ends in L, and the size field says large. The title has been copied from medium.

03 **Joel:** Both rows use HARBOR-TEE as their group. Should I change the large row to a completely different group to separate them?

04 **Sana:** No. The shared [2] _____ connects variants of the same shirt. Keep distinct item IDs and the correct size on each row.

05 **Joel:** Then the parent group is not a stock pool. Twenty large shirts cannot support a promise of twenty medium shirts.

06 **Sana:** Exactly. The [3] _____ is already correct for large. Fix the misleading title rather than changing that accurate field to match it.

Conversation / continued

07 **Joel:** The image shows the blue shirt. It would look the same in medium and large. That may be why the mistake survived the visual check.

08 **Sana:** Yes. An image can confirm color and style without proving size. Check the identifiers and supplied product data, not the thumbnail alone.

09 **Joel:** The link also opens medium by default. If we change only the title, the shopper could still land on the wrong selection.

10 **Sana:** We need the [4] _____ to match the large offer. Test the actual feed link, not just navigation from the main product page.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The right shirt, the wrong variant

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Joel:** The barcode field is verified as large. Should I copy medium's barcode so all the grouped rows share one?

12 **Sana:** No. Preserve the verified [5] _____. Sharing a product group does not make different trade-item identifiers interchangeable. Do not invent a replacement number either.

13 **Joel:** I will leave the correct stock, size, and identifier alone. The title and the link selection are the two confirmed corrections.

14 **Sana:** Right. Then preview both variants separately. A fix for large should not change medium's zero availability or turn the group record into a purchasable extra item.

15 **Joel:** Can I tell the trading team the listing is fixed as soon as I save the source file?

16 **Sana:** Not yet. Check the [6] _____ and the displayed offer after ingestion. Record any delay or rejection instead of assuming the update has propagated.

17 **Joel:** I will test the large shopping result through to the selected large item and confirm the stock still shows twenty.

18 **Sana:** And test medium separately: correct medium title, medium selection, and zero availability. That second check catches accidental changes to the sibling variant.

19 **Joel:** My handoff will list both SKUs, their size and stock, the corrected title and link, and the destination check. No inventory adjustment is needed from these facts.

20 **Sana:** Good. We are repairing the offer mapping, not manufacturing stock or changing the shirt. That is the distinction the support team needs when answering the next query.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. variant SKU / **2.** item group ID / **3.** size attribute / **4.** landing-page selection / **5.** GTIN / **6.** processed feed

Why these answers fit, page 157

Read the variant, not just the group

Fictional red cap: medium SKU RC-M has 0 available; large SKU RC-L has 12. Both share group RED-CAP. The large feed row wrongly says medium in its title; its size field and verified GTIN correctly identify large.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

RED-CAP / 0 / RC-L / GTIN

01 **Merchandiser:** The twelve available units belong to SKU [1] _____.

02 **Specialist:** The shared group identifier is [2] _____.

03 **Merchandiser:** Medium's available quantity remains [3] _____.

04 **Specialist:** Correct the large row's title, not its already verified [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. RC-L / **2.** RED-CAP / **3.** 0 / **4.** GTIN

Why these answers fit, page 157

Keep the distinction audible

Resolve a catalog mismatch by reading back identifiers and distinguishing variant data from product-group data.

Language for the next case

Two discounts, two calculation bases

product discount

The product discount takes twenty percent from the original $100 product price, leaving $80 before the order discount is calculated.

Grace: Not for this setup. The product discount reduces the hundred-dollar item to eighty. The next ten percent uses eighty as its base.

order discount

The order discount is ten percent of the already reduced $80 merchandise subtotal, so it removes $8 under the supplied combination rules.

Grace: Yes. This order discount follows the product discount. The combined merchandise saving is twenty-eight dollars, or twenty-eight percent of the original price.

shipping threshold

The shipping threshold is assessed after both discounts in this fictional offer; the relevant subtotal is $72, below the $75 minimum.

Grace: The shipping threshold is checked after both discounts. Seventy-two falls below seventy-five, so the five-dollar shipping charge applies.

merchandise subtotal

The merchandise subtotal is $72 after both discounts, while the final payable total is $77 after adding the separate $5 shipping charge.

Grace: Correct. The merchandise subtotal and final total need separate labels. A shipping charge is not a reversal of the product discount.

combination eligibility

Combination eligibility determines whether the two offers may apply together; the supplied test allows this combination, but that does not establish other discount pairings.

Grace: Also confirm combination eligibility in the actual checkout. An entered code is not proof that its discount applied successfully.

checkout summary

The checkout summary records the applied discounts, shipping basis, and payable total; it allows the displayed offer to be checked against the actual calculation.

Grace: Include the checkout summary and the approved conditions. Test a qualifying basket separately instead of assuming this below-threshold basket covers both outcomes.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Two discounts, two calculation bases

Fictional tested offer: a $100 product gets a 20% product discount, followed by a combinable 10% order discount on the reduced merchandise subtotal. Free shipping requires at least $75 AFTER both discounts; otherwise shipping is $5. No tax or other charge. These rules are supplied for this offer, not every platform or combination.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

combination eligibility / order discount / merchandise subtotal / product discount / shipping threshold / checkout summary

01 **Emil:** The banner says thirty percent off with free shipping. We have twenty percent off the product and another ten percent at checkout. Does that wording work?

02 **Grace:** Not for this setup. The [1] _____ reduces the hundred-dollar item to eighty. The next ten percent uses eighty as its base.

03 **Emil:** So the checkout discount is eight dollars, not another ten. That leaves seventy-two for the merchandise.

04 **Grace:** Yes. This [2] _____ follows the product discount. The combined merchandise saving is twenty-eight dollars, or twenty-eight percent of the original price.

05 **Emil:** I added the percentages because both messages used percent off. The different bases are what make that calculation wrong here.

06 **Grace:** Exactly. We should say twenty percent off the product, then an extra ten percent off the reduced subtotal. Show the final example price as well.

Conversation / continued

07 **Emil:** What about free shipping? The original price is a hundred, and even the first discounted amount is eighty. Both are above seventy-five.

08 **Grace:** The [3] _____ is checked after both discounts. Seventy-two falls below seventy-five, so the five-dollar shipping charge applies.

09 **Emil:** That makes the payable total seventy-seven, with no tax or other charge in this test. It is not seventy dollars delivered.

10 **Grace:** Correct. The [4] _____ and final total need separate labels. A shipping charge is not a reversal of the product discount.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two discounts, two calculation bases

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Emil:** Can we increase the free-shipping threshold calculation to the pre-discount price instead? That would make the banner easier to keep.

12 **Grace:** That would be a different commercial rule requiring an approved change and retest. Do not change the interpretation simply to rescue wording already drafted.

13 **Emil:** Fair. I will correct the banner to match the approved offer. We can show the free-shipping condition beside it rather than imply everyone qualifies.

14 **Grace:** Also confirm [5] _____ in the actual checkout. An entered code is not proof that its discount applied successfully.

15 **Emil:** Should our support script say percentages always apply one after another? That would be a quick explanation for agents.

16 **Grace:** No. Other classes and configurations can use the same base or disallow combining. Explain this product-then-order sequence without turning it into a universal rule.

17 **Emil:** For the test record, I will capture the starting hundred, twenty off, eight off, seventy-two subtotal, five shipping, and seventy-seven total.

18 **Grace:** Include the [6] _____ and the approved conditions. Test a qualifying basket separately instead of assuming this below-threshold basket covers both outcomes.

19 **Emil:** Then the revised message can give the seventy-two merchandise price and state that this basket has five-dollar shipping. No thirty-percent or free-shipping claim for it.

20 **Grace:** That works. Send the corrected copy and the captured calculation together so merchandising, support, and the checkout team all explain the same offer.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. product discount / **2.** order discount / **3.** shipping threshold / **4.** merchandise subtotal / **5.** combination eligibility / **6.** checkout summary

Why these answers fit, page 159

Check the threshold after both reductions

Fictional offer: $200 product, 25% product discount, then 10% order discount on the reduced subtotal. Free shipping starts at $140 AFTER both discounts; otherwise $6. No tax or other charges.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

135 / 141 / 150 / below

01 **Executive:** After the product discount, the subtotal is [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Analyst:** After the order discount, merchandise costs [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Executive:** Shipping is charged because that subtotal is [3] _____ the threshold.

04 **Analyst:** Including shipping, the total is [4] _____ dollars.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 150 / **2.** 135 / **3.** below / **4.** 141

Why these answers fit, page 159

Keep the distinction audible

Explain an offer using its actual combination order and eligibility threshold, then agree precise customer-facing wording.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

D. 80%

Eighty units sold divided by one hundred opening units equals eighty percent.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. How many units remain in Range B?

A. 80

Two hundred opening units minus one hundred twenty sold leaves eighty units.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What is not yet established?

C. Which range has higher gross profit

Product costs are missing, so equal revenue does not establish relative gross profit.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.

Each range needs its own opening-unit denominator; revenue does not replace that stock base.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which claim needs product costs?

B. A earned more gross profit than B.

Gross profit subtracts product costs, which the briefing does not supply.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base. Which term fits?

B. sell-through

A Not here. gross margin return on inventory: Gross profit relative to average inventory cost. The usual combination is "evaluate inventory return".

B Correct. sell-through: Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base. The usual combination is "calculate unit sell-through".

C Not here. option count: The number of distinct product choices in a range. The usual combination is "review the option count".

D Not here. seasonal line: A line intended for a particular selling season. The usual combination is "exit a seasonal line".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season." Cal: [missing response] Inez: "Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Exactly. The markdown helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Inez says: "Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Inez says: "B did sell forty more units. I do not want the team to lose sight of that demand when we review the range." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Inez says: "I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Cal's response in turn 6. It connects Inez's preceding point with Inez's follow-up. Markdown names the price reduction used to support B's sales, not the sales volume itself.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. sell-through

Turn 2. Sell-through compares sold units with the defined stock base, revealing a difference that equal revenue hides.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. residual stock

Turn 4. Residual stock is the inventory left after sales; B retains eighty units while A retains twenty.

3. markdown

Turn 6. Markdown names the price reduction used to support B's sales, not the sales volume itself.

4. delisting

Turn 8. Delisting removes a product from the active range; the evidence does not yet justify removing all of B.

5. size curve

Turn 10. The size curve describes the unit distribution across sizes, which may explain uneven leftover stock.

6. customer segment

Turn 12. Customer segment identifies the group served by a range and helps assess its distinct commercial role.

7. buying budget

Turn 14. Buying budget names the money allocated to merchandise purchases, constraining the proposed initial order.

8. gross margin return on inventory

Turn 16. This measure relates gross profit to average inventory cost, requiring cost and investment information absent here.

9. range review

Turn 18. Range review is the structured assessment bringing together sales, stock, pricing, and the role of the selection.

10. assortment depth

Turn 20. Assortment depth concerns the variety of options within a line, such as sizes and colorways; units held per option are stock depth.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

C. Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.

Variant and segment evidence supports a more specific decision than the aggregate result alone.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. Which wording states a condition?

B. We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.

Once makes the proposed action depend on completing the specified review.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. 75%

Buyer: C has a sell-through rate of 75%.

Turn 1. Forty-five sold units divided by sixty opening units equals seventy-five percent.

2. 50%

Planner: D has a sell-through rate of 50%.

Turn 2. Sixty sold units divided by one hundred twenty opening units equals fifty percent.

3. 15

Buyer: C has 15 units remaining.

Turn 3. Sixty opening units less forty-five sold leaves fifteen remaining units.

4. 60

Planner: D has 60 units remaining.

Turn 4. One hundred twenty opening units less sixty sold leaves sixty remaining units.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "Could we call for a smaller initial order, with more room to react later?" Cal: [missing response] Inez: "Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. We can propose that within the buying budget, but supplier lead times and minimum quantities still need checking. Flexibility on paper is not always available in the supply arrangement.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Inez says: "I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Inez says: "Both ranges brought in twelve thousand. Can we repeat the buy? B needed more promotional support, but I do not want to cut a range customers still use." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Inez says: "We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Cal's response in turn 14. It connects Inez's preceding point with Inez's follow-up. Buying budget names the money allocated to merchandise purchases, constraining the proposed initial order.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What was promotion revenue?

A. $5,100

One hundred twenty units multiplied by forty-two dollars fifty equals five thousand one hundred dollars.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

C. $1,500

Revenue of $5,100 less product costs of $3,600 leaves $1,500 gross profit.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. Which cost is excluded?

D. Operating expenses

The brief includes unit product cost but explicitly excludes operating expenses.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

C. Revenue rose 2%.

The new quantity factor 1.20 multiplied by price factor 0.85 gives revenue factor 1.02.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. What happened to gross profit?

D. It fell from $2,000 to $1,500.

Baseline gross profit is 100 times $20; promotion gross profit is 120 times $12.50.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Product costs attributable to the units sold. Which term fits?

A. cost of goods sold

A Correct. cost of goods sold: Product costs attributable to the units sold. The usual combination is "deduct cost of goods sold".

B Not here. baseline: The reference level used for comparison. The usual combination is "establish a baseline".

C Not here. halo effect: A related benefit beyond the promoted product itself. The usual combination is "test for a halo effect".

D Not here. funding allowance: A contribution toward promotion costs under agreed terms. The usual combination is "verify a funding allowance".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Because cost of goods sold also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Hugo says: "Units were up twenty percent. I have called that a profit improvement in the trading note. Can you check the wording before I send it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Hugo says: "So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 6. It connects Hugo's preceding point with Hugo's follow-up. Cost of goods sold includes thirty dollars for each sold unit, rising as unit volume increases.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Hugo says: "Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. unit volume

Turn 2. Unit volume counts units sold; the twenty-percent increase does not alone establish revenue or profit improvement.

2. Sales revenue

Turn 4. Sales revenue is price multiplied by units here; it rose from five thousand to five thousand one hundred dollars.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. cost of goods sold

Turn 6. Cost of goods sold includes thirty dollars for each sold unit, rising as unit volume increases.

4. gross profit

Turn 8. Gross profit subtracts product costs from revenue; the resulting amounts are two thousand and fifteen hundred dollars.

5. unit gross profit

Turn 10. Unit gross profit subtracts the thirty-dollar product cost from each selling price, producing twenty dollars and twelve fifty.

6. break-even volume

Turn 12. Break-even volume here is explicitly the quantity needed to match prior gross profit, not company-wide net-profit break-even.

7. baseline

Turn 14. Baseline identifies the reference week against which this promotion is compared, not proof of wider customer benefits.

8. funding allowance

Turn 16. Funding allowance is supplier support under agreed terms; an unconfirmed possibility must not be booked as an established benefit.

9. gross margin percentage

Turn 18. Gross margin percentage divides gross profit by revenue; fifteen hundred over fifty-one hundred is approximately twenty-nine point four percent.

10. margin dilution

Turn 20. Margin dilution names the reduction in the profit margin, allowing a balanced account alongside the higher sales volume.

Return to the conversation, page 20

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

D. 160

The $2,000 baseline divided by $12.50 unit gross profit requires 160 units.

Return to the exercise, page 22

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

D. The campaign acquired profitable new customers.

No customer-acquisition or customer-profitability evidence is supplied by the weekly sales figures.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F / Guided speaking

1. 4,000

Manager: Baseline revenue was 4,000 dollars.

Turn 1. Fifty units multiplied by eighty dollars yields four thousand dollars of revenue.

2. 4,200

Analyst: Promotion revenue was 4,200 dollars.

Turn 2. Sixty units multiplied by seventy dollars yields four thousand two hundred dollars.

3. 1,500

Manager: Baseline gross profit was 1,500 dollars.

Turn 3. Fifty units times the thirty-dollar unit gross profit gives fifteen hundred dollars.

4. 1,200

Analyst: Promotion gross profit was 1,200 dollars.

Turn 4. Sixty units times the twenty-dollar unit gross profit gives twelve hundred dollars.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "The buyer mentioned possible supplier funding. Do we have an agreed amount, or should I leave it out of this result?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this baseline comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Hugo says: "So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Hugo says: "Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 14. It connects Hugo's preceding point with Hugo's follow-up. Baseline identifies the reference week against which this promotion is compared, not proof of wider customer benefits.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Hugo says: "Units were up twenty percent. I have called that a profit improvement in the trading note. Can you check the wording before I send it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

A. 30

One hundred on-hand units less sixty committed and ten held leaves thirty available.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A2. How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

D. None

The brief explicitly separates twenty incoming units from the one hundred physically on hand.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A3. What is established for Store East?

B. It has no units.

Store East has zero units, so warehouse stock cannot establish local pickup readiness.

Return to the exercise, page 26

D / Response choices

D1. Which website claim is supported now?

B. Store East has no stock for pickup.

The local store has no units; the warehouse total does not change that fact.

Return to the exercise, page 30

D2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

C. 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.

Both existing commitments and the quality hold must be removed from the on-hand total.

Return to the exercise, page 30

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Held stock not currently eligible for sale. Which term fits?

B. unavailable inventory

A Not here. fulfillment eligibility: Whether an item and location may serve a specified order. The usual combination is "check fulfillment eligibility".

B Correct. unavailable inventory: Held stock not currently eligible for sale. The usual combination is "classify unavailable inventory".

C Not here. available to promise: Quantity that can be committed under defined fulfillment rules. The usual combination is "calculate available to promise".

D Not here. lead time: Elapsed time between defined order and supply milestones. The usual combination is "verify replenishment lead time".

Return to the exercise, page 30

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The national total cannot promise store pickup". Anika: "We also have twenty on the way. Someone added them to the website quantity." Miro: [missing response] Anika: "Could we use the ten held units until the next shipment arrives?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Keep incoming inventory separate. Those twenty have not been received. Adding them to current sellable stock would create a promise we cannot support from this snapshot.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Anika says: "That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Anika says: "Even at the warehouse, can we sell all one hundred to new customers?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Anika says: "I will remove the Store East pickup claim. Could we offer delivery from the warehouse instead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Miro's response in turn 6. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. Incoming inventory is expected stock not yet received; it must not be counted as already held at this warehouse.

Return to the exercise, page 30

E / Conversation

1. inventory snapshot

Turn 2. Inventory snapshot fixes the quantity and status at a particular time; these records describe the position at nine.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. on-hand inventory

Turn 4. On-hand inventory includes all physically held units in this case, including commitments and units on quality hold.

3. incoming inventory

Turn 6. Incoming inventory is expected stock not yet received; it must not be counted as already held at this warehouse.

4. quality hold

Turn 8. Quality hold restricts the ten units pending review; commercial demand does not itself authorize their release.

5. committed inventory

Turn 10. Committed inventory is allocated to existing demand and cannot be treated as unassigned stock for another sale.

6. fulfillment eligibility

Turn 12. Fulfillment eligibility establishes whether this item and warehouse may serve the proposed order and delivery route.

7. stock reservation

Turn 14. Stock reservation assigns stock to a particular demand; a general available balance does not establish that assignment.

8. inventory feed

Turn 16. Inventory feed supplies stock information to the website; its location and state mapping must support the displayed promise.

9. transfer order

Turn 18. Transfer order records an authorized inter-location movement; it does not prove the receiving store already has the goods.

10. location-level availability

Turn 20. Location-level availability ties sellable quantities to a specific site, preventing warehouse inventory from implying local pickup readiness.

Return to the conversation, page 32

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which step requires a separate check?

B. Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route

The brief leaves delivery eligibility unconfirmed despite the warehouse having thirty available units.

Return to the exercise, page 34

F2. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

B. The replenishment has arrived at Store East.

A proposed stock movement does not establish physical receipt at the receiving store.

Return to the exercise, page 34

F / Guided speaking

1. 30

Trader: The available warehouse quantity is 30.

Turn 1. Eighty on hand minus forty-five committed and five held leaves thirty available.

2. five

Controller: The held quantity is five.

Turn 2. The briefing explicitly identifies five units as held rather than available for sale.

3. twelve

Trader: The incoming quantity is twelve.

Turn 3. Twelve units are expected separately and are not part of on-hand stock.

4. zero

Controller: Store South's current quantity is zero.

Turn 4. The warehouse quantities do not change Store South's explicitly stated zero stock.

Return to the conversation, page 35

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The national total cannot promise store pickup". Anika: "If delivery is possible, can I say we have put one aside? I have not created a reservation yet." Miro: [missing response] Anika: "That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Only after the actual stock reservation is confirmed. Other orders may arrive after our snapshot. Refresh the quantity before offering a specific commitment.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Anika says: "The store manager has asked for a warehouse transfer. Can we mark the store replenished?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Anika says: "I will show no pickup stock at East, check the warehouse delivery route, and raise the feed correction." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Anika says: "I will remove the Store East pickup claim. Could we offer delivery from the warehouse instead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Miro's response in turn 14. It connects Anika's preceding point with Anika's follow-up. Stock reservation assigns stock to a particular demand; a general available balance does not establish that assignment.

Return to the exercise, page 35

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is confirmed?

A. The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.

Physical handoff on 4 May is established; delivery and remedies remain unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A2. What does 14:00 today represent?

C. A status update

The agent promises a communication update, not any unconfirmed shipment or financial outcome.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A3. What is unknown?

D. The revised arrival time

The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time in the supplied record.

Return to the exercise, page 36

D / Response choices

D1. Which response is both honest and useful?

A. The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.

The supported response combines the real uncertainty with an action and a communication commitment.

Return to the exercise, page 40

D2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

D. Physical carrier handoff on 4 May

The briefing establishes actual carrier possession, not merely preparation or an estimated future event.

Return to the exercise, page 40

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee. Which term fits?

D. estimated delivery date

A Not here. partial fulfillment: Supply of only part of an order. The usual combination is "record partial fulfillment".

B Not here. return authorization: Permission or reference for a return under a process. The usual combination is "issue a return authorization".

C Not here. last mile: The final transport stage to the recipient. The usual combination is "coordinate last-mile delivery".

D Correct. estimated delivery date: A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee. The usual combination is "revise an estimated delivery date".

Return to the exercise, page 40

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?" Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I cannot confirm a new delivery window yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Laila says: "Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 6. It connects Laila's preceding point with Laila's follow-up. Delivery window identifies an expected or scheduled arrival interval; no revised interval is confirmed here.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Laila says: "My order was due yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking has stopped changing. Can you tell me whether the carrier actually has it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Laila says: "I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 40

E / Conversation

1. estimated delivery date

Turn 2. Estimated delivery date names the projected arrival that has passed; it is not proof that delivery occurred.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. carrier handoff

Turn 4. Carrier handoff means the parcel was physically transferred to the transport provider, which is established for 4 May.

3. delivery window

Turn 6. Delivery window identifies an expected or scheduled arrival interval; no revised interval is confirmed here.

4. carrier inquiry

Turn 8. Carrier inquiry is the concrete request for shipment investigation that the agent is authorized to initiate.

5. tracking event

Turn 10. Tracking event is a recorded shipment milestone; checking it supports an update without guaranteeing a future arrival.

6. replacement order

Turn 12. Replacement order supplies another item, but this record contains no authorization for the agent to promise one.

7. refund authorization

Turn 14. Refund authorization is approval for returning payment; the agent must not imply an approval that the record lacks.

8. delivery exception

Turn 16. Delivery exception identifies an interruption to the expected process; it requires investigation rather than an invented lost-parcel finding.

9. service recovery

Turn 18. Service recovery concerns addressing the customer experience after the delay, including accountable follow-up and checking available remedies.

10. dispatch

Turn 20. Dispatch concerns sending the goods; it must remain separate from the still-unconfirmed arrival at the customer's address.

Return to the conversation, page 42

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which promise is not supported?

A. A replacement will arrive tomorrow.

Neither replacement authorization nor a replacement arrival date is supplied.

Return to the exercise, page 44

F2. What should a pending-carrier update do?

D. State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.

An honest update preserves the commitment without fabricating an answer or excluding applicable rights.

Return to the exercise, page 44

F / Guided speaking

1. 12 June

Agent: Carrier handoff occurred on 12 June.

Turn 1. Twelve June is the confirmed physical handoff date, not the estimated arrival.

2. 14 June

Customer: The original estimated arrival was 14 June.

Turn 2. Fourteen June is the supplied estimate that has already passed.

3. unconfirmed

Agent: The revised arrival time remains unconfirmed.

Turn 3. No new arrival time is established by the facts in this exchange.

4. 16:00

Customer: The next status update is at 16:00.

Turn 4. Sixteen hundred is the contact commitment and must not become a delivery guarantee.

Return to the conversation, page 45

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need." Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "The missing scans worry me. Does that mean the parcel is lost?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will check that rather than invent a refund authorization. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Laila says: "Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 14. It connects Laila's preceding point with Laila's follow-up. Refund authorization is approval for returning payment; the agent must not imply an approval that the record lacks.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Laila says: "My order was due yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking has stopped changing. Can you tell me whether the carrier actually has it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Laila says: "The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is the later conversion rate?

D. 32%

Three hundred twenty completed purchasing sessions divided by one thousand eligible sessions equals thirty-two percent.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A2. What is the absolute rate decline?

D. Eight percentage points

Forty percent minus thirty-two percent is eight percentage points.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A3. Which causal conclusion is established?

D. The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.

The outage and unverified comparability prevent this comparison from isolating one cause.

Return to the exercise, page 48

D / Response choices

D1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

D. Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.

The absolute difference is eight points; eight divided by the original forty is twenty percent.

Return to the exercise, page 52

D2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

D. Eligible checkout sessions

The briefing explicitly defines conversion using the eligible checkout-session base.

Return to the exercise, page 52

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria. Which term fits?

A. eligible session

A Correct. eligible session: A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria. The usual combination is "define eligible sessions".

B Not here. payment gateway: A service connecting a checkout to payment processing. The usual combination is "monitor the payment gateway".

C Not here. cohort: A group sharing a defined characteristic or starting event. The usual combination is "define a cohort".

D Not here. denominator: The base quantity used in a rate calculation. The usual combination is "keep the denominator consistent".

Return to the exercise, page 52

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A checkout decline with two competing explanations". Mara: "Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?" Dev: [missing response] Mara: "The payment provider was down during part of the later period. That seems important." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. No. A common denominator count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Mara says: "Checkout is down after the redesign. The release team wants a rollback recommendation this morning. What can we actually conclude from this chart?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mara says: "I wrote an eight-percent decline in my draft. Is that the clearest description?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 6. It connects Mara's preceding point with Mara's follow-up. Denominator is the rate's base; equal base counts do not guarantee equal populations, conditions, or measurement.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Mara says: "The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 52

E / Conversation

1. checkout conversion

Turn 2. Checkout conversion uses completed purchasing sessions over eligible checkout sessions, giving forty percent before and thirty-two percent after.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. percentage points

Turn 4. Percentage points express the absolute difference between the forty-percent and thirty-two-percent rates.

3. denominator

Turn 6. Denominator is the rate's base; equal base counts do not guarantee equal populations, conditions, or measurement.

4. provider outage

Turn 8. Provider outage names the concurrent service disruption that complicates attributing the whole decline to the redesign.

5. traffic mix

Turn 10. Traffic mix describes the composition of sessions; differences between intervals can complicate interpreting their conversion rates.

6. event instrumentation

Turn 12. Event instrumentation is the collection implementation; a change can alter what is recorded even when behavior is unchanged.

7. deduplication

Turn 14. Deduplication handles repeated records; the session-based definition also requires counting each purchasing session at most once.

8. device segment

Turn 16. Device segment groups sessions by device type, allowing the team to locate patterns hidden by the aggregate rate.

9. rollback

Turn 18. Rollback returns to an earlier version; deciding on it requires the relevant operational risks and evidence, not a fabricated causal certainty.

10. causal attribution

Turn 20. Causal attribution assigns an outcome to a cause; this comparison supports an observed decline but not an isolated redesign effect.

Return to the conversation, page 54

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement overclaims causality?

A. The redesign caused the entire decline.

A concurrent outage and unverified comparability leave the redesign's isolated effect unresolved.

Return to the exercise, page 56

F2. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

B. Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.

Segment comparisons can reveal patterns, but differing populations or timing may still complicate causality.

Return to the exercise, page 56

F / Guided speaking

1. 50%

Lead: The original rate was 50%.

Turn 1. Three hundred purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals fifty percent.

2. 40%

Analyst: The later rate was 40%.

Turn 2. Two hundred forty purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals forty percent.

3. ten percentage points

Lead: The absolute decline was ten percentage points.

Turn 3. Fifty percent minus forty percent is an absolute ten-percentage-point difference.

4. 20%

Analyst: The relative decline was 20%.

Turn 4. Ten percentage points divided by the original fifty-percent rate equals a twenty-percent relative decline.

Return to the conversation, page 57

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A checkout decline with two competing explanations". Mara: "The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?" Dev: [missing response] Mara: "So the same session could produce several recorded events without becoming several successful sessions." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Not necessarily. Check deduplication and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.

A Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 14. It connects Mara's preceding point with Mara's follow-up. Deduplication handles repeated records; the session-based definition also requires counting each purchasing session at most once.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Mara says: "Checkout is down after the redesign. The release team wants a rollback recommendation this morning. What can we actually conclude from this chart?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Mara says: "Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Mara says: "I wrote an eight-percent decline in my draft. Is that the clearest description?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 57

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

D. 1.25%

Ten defective units divided by eight hundred received units equals one point two five percent.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

C. 2.5%

Five defective units divided by two hundred received units equals two point five percent.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A3. What remains unverified?

D. Comparable product mix and inspection intensity

The brief explicitly leaves product mix and inspection intensity unconfirmed as comparable.

Return to the exercise, page 58

D / Response choices

D1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

D. K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.

K's 1.25% rate is below M's 2.5% rate on the stated received-unit bases.

Return to the exercise, page 62

D2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

C. As one defective unit

The case explicitly counts each defective unit once regardless of its number of faults.

Return to the exercise, page 62

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Units recorded as received within the defined scope. Which term fits?

C. received units

A Not here. sample size: The number of units examined in a sample. The usual combination is "state the sample size".

B Not here. vendor allowance: A supplier-funded amount under agreed commercial terms. The usual combination is "verify a vendor allowance".

C Correct. received units: Units recorded as received within the defined scope. The usual combination is "confirm received units".

D Not here. content compliance: Conformity with applicable product-content requirements. The usual combination is "review content compliance".

Return to the exercise, page 62

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "They all relate to July. Some units had several faults; the inspection team counted each affected unit once." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Please also state the reporting period. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Rosa says: "Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 6. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Reporting period fixes both numerator and denominator to July receipts so the comparison does not mix intervals.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Rosa says: "Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Rosa says: "Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 62

E / Conversation

1. received units

Turn 2. Received units supply the stated rate denominator; ten and five alone are counts rather than rates.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. defective-unit rate

Turn 4. Defective-unit rate divides defective units by received units here, yielding 1.25 percent for K and 2.5 percent for M.

3. reporting period

Turn 6. Reporting period fixes both numerator and denominator to July receipts so the comparison does not mix intervals.

4. defect count

Turn 8. Defect count counts individual faults; several faults on one unit must not become several defective units in this metric.

5. product mix

Turn 10. Product mix describes the goods included; different products can limit a claim about inherent comparative supplier quality.

6. inspection record

Turn 12. Inspection record supplies traceable findings and examination details needed to investigate the reported defective units.

7. root cause

Turn 14. Root cause is the supported underlying reason; the conversation supplies only an unconfirmed packaging hypothesis.

8. chargeback

Turn 16. Chargeback is a commercial deduction or charge whose basis must follow the applicable agreement, not the scorecard alone.

9. remediation plan

Turn 18. Remediation plan sets out actions addressing the problem once the evidence supports what needs to change.

10. vendor scorecard

Turn 20. Vendor scorecard should present defined measures accurately while leaving unresolved cause and commercial questions visible.

Return to the conversation, page 64

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which claim still needs investigation?

A. K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.

Product mix and inspection intensity may differ, so inherent comparative quality is not established.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F2. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

B. Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice

Commercial deductions require their applicable terms and basis, not just a performance label.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F / Guided speaking

1. 1%

Manager: P's defective-unit rate is 1%.

Turn 1. Six divided by six hundred equals one percent on the specified received-unit basis.

2. 2%

Supplier: Q's defective-unit rate is 2%.

Turn 2. Four divided by two hundred equals two percent on the specified received-unit basis.

3. P

Manager: The larger defective-unit count belongs to P.

Turn 3. P has six defective units compared with Q's four, so its count is larger.

4. Q

Supplier: The higher defective-unit rate belongs to Q.

Turn 4. Q's two-percent rate exceeds P's one-percent rate despite Q's smaller defective-unit count.

Return to the conversation, page 67

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed root cause. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Rosa says: "You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Rosa says: "Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 14. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Root cause is the supported underlying reason; the conversation supplies only an unconfirmed packaging hypothesis.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Rosa says: "Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 67

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

B. He changed his mind.

The briefing specifies a change of mind and supplies no fault or misdescription allegation.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A2. What can Elena authorize herself?

C. Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception

Elena can submit the request but does not hold the stated exception-approval authority.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

D. As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights

The policy informs the request, but actual customer rights and transaction facts still require checking.

Return to the exercise, page 70

D / Response choices

D1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

B. I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.

Elena can submit the request but cannot approve or promise the review result.

Return to the exercise, page 74

D2. Which record best matches the stated request?

C. Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; $80 purchase

The correct record preserves the actual reason, condition, timing, and amount without inventing an outcome.

Return to the exercise, page 74

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: The defined power to approve a policy departure. Which term fits?

B. exception authority

A Not here. store credit: Value available for a future purchase from the retailer. The usual combination is "explain store credit".

B Correct. exception authority: The defined power to approve a policy departure. The usual combination is "confirm exception authority".

C Not here. review outcome: The result of an assessment. The usual combination is "communicate the review outcome".

D Not here. applicable rights: Customer protections relevant to the actual transaction. The usual combination is "check applicable rights".

Return to the exercise, page 74

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A return request beyond the goodwill window". Owen: "I am not saying there is anything wrong with it. I simply chose the wrong style for myself." Elena: [missing response] Owen: "If you send it to the manager, does that mean I will get the money back?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will record that accurately. I can request a goodwill exception, but I cannot approve one myself. The store manager can assess the request under the relevant process.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Owen says: "Please include the receipt details in the handoff. I would rather not start again when the manager responds." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 6. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Goodwill exception is a permitted discretionary departure from policy; requesting it does not establish approval or replace applicable rights.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Owen says: "Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Owen says: "That is clear. For now, it is just the style, and I would like the review." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 74

E / Conversation

1. change-of-mind return

Turn 2. Change-of-mind return accurately identifies Owen's stated reason, rather than inventing a fault or misdescription.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. return window

Turn 4. Return window is the retailer's stated thirty-day period for this purchase, not a universal legal limit.

3. goodwill exception

Turn 6. Goodwill exception is a permitted discretionary departure from policy; requesting it does not establish approval or replace applicable rights.

4. manager review

Turn 8. Manager review is the assessment step Elena can submit; its result is not supplied or guaranteed.

5. store credit

Turn 10. Store credit is value for a future purchase; it also requires an actual available or approved basis here.

6. proof of purchase

Turn 12. Proof of purchase identifies the transaction and its details, supporting the review without requiring a fabricated outcome.

7. exception authority

Turn 14. Exception authority identifies who may approve a policy departure; Elena's submission does not transfer that decision power to her.

8. fault allegation

Turn 16. Fault allegation is a reported defect requiring its own assessment; it must not be automatically rejected under the goodwill window.

9. complaint record

Turn 18. Complaint record preserves the customer's actual concern, supplied details, and handling without turning a request into an approved remedy.

10. service handoff

Turn 20. Service handoff transfers accurate context and responsibility, including the distinction between a submitted review and its eventual outcome.

Return to the conversation, page 76

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

B. Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.

A fault allegation raises a different assessment and cannot be decided merely from this change-of-mind policy.

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F2. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

C. Would you like me to submit the review?

The question offers a specific submission action while leaving the review decision unmade.

Return to the exercise, page 78

F / Guided speaking

1. 22

Noor: The request is on day 22.

Turn 1. Twenty-two is the request day stated for this separate transaction.

2. 14

Customer: The stated policy window is 14 days.

Turn 2. Fourteen days is the fictional policy period, not an invented universal legal rule.

3. Beth

Noor: The manager reviewing the request is Beth.

Turn 3. Beth is the named manager; Noor only submits the review.

4. approval

Customer: Submission does not guarantee approval.

Turn 4. A submitted review is not the same as an approved exception or remedy.

Return to the conversation, page 79

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A return request beyond the goodwill window". Owen: "I have the receipt and the jacket with its tags. Please submit the request." Elena: [missing response] Owen: "Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will. The manager has the exception authority described in our process. I will keep your reason and preferred outcomes clear rather than suggest the jacket is faulty to make the request sound stronger.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Owen says: "All right. What information does the manager need from me?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Owen says: "I paid eighty dollars for this jacket and have not worn it. I chose the wrong style. I am five days outside the return window; is a review possible?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Elena's response in turn 14. It connects Owen's preceding point with Owen's follow-up. Exception authority identifies who may approve a policy departure; Elena's submission does not transfer that decision power to her.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Owen says: "The receipt says thirty days. Is there any way to ask someone to look at it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 79

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which item has not been located?

A. The mug

The briefing identifies the mug as missing while the other two items are staged.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

B. Every ordered item verified and staged

The local rule requires all ordered items, not just part of the order, to be verified and staged.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A3. Who owns the next customer contact?

B. Evan

Evan is the incoming lead assigned to contact the customer and update the case.

Return to the exercise, page 80

D / Response choices

D1. Which handoff is actionable?

D. P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.

The detailed handoff preserves physical facts, the system mismatch, responsibility, and the next checkpoint.

Return to the exercise, page 84

D2. Which substitution claim is supported?

C. No substitute has been approved.

The briefing explicitly leaves substitution unapproved and does not supply customer consent.

Return to the exercise, page 84

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status. Which term fits?

B. order management system (OMS)

A Not here. pickup shelf: The area holding orders prepared for collection. The usual combination is "check the pickup shelf".

B Correct. order management system (OMS): Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status. The usual combination is "update the OMS".

C Not here. customer consent: The customer's agreement to a proposed action. The usual combination is "obtain customer consent".

D Not here. shift handoff: Transfer of work status and responsibility between shifts. The usual combination is "give a shift handoff".

Return to the exercise, page 84

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey." Evan: [missing response] Talia: "Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will address the pickup notification and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Talia says: "If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Evan's response in turn 6. It connects Talia's preceding point with Talia's follow-up. Pickup notification communicates collection readiness; an inaccurate ready message needs correction and direct customer follow-up.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Talia says: "The mug has not been found. The notebook and pen set are identified for P64 and are already in the designated holding area." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Talia says: "I will list the locations already checked so your team does not repeat the same search." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 84

E / Conversation

1. order-level status

Turn 2. Order-level status describes the whole order; ready is unsupported when one of the three required items is missing.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. staging

Turn 4. Staging places the picked items in the holding area; it confirms preparation of two items, not completion of all three.

3. pickup notification

Turn 6. Pickup notification communicates collection readiness; an inaccurate ready message needs correction and direct customer follow-up.

4. partial pickup

Turn 8. Partial pickup supplies only part of the order and needs the permitted process plus the customer's agreement here.

5. substitution

Turn 10. Substitution provides a different item; the nearby mug cannot replace the ordered one without the necessary approval and agreement.

6. short pick

Turn 12. Short pick identifies the unfulfilled picking quantity, keeping the missing mug visible instead of treating the order as complete.

7. action owner

Turn 14. Action owner identifies Evan as responsible for the next customer contact, preventing the task from being lost between shifts.

8. refund status

Turn 16. Refund status records the actual payment-return stage; a cancellation request or missing item does not itself establish a completed refund.

9. discrepancy log

Turn 18. Discrepancy log preserves the mismatch between physical items and system status, together with ownership and follow-up information.

10. resolution checkpoint

Turn 20. Resolution checkpoint is the scheduled progress review at sixteen thirty, not an automatic completion or refund event.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does 16:30 mean?

B. A case-update checkpoint

Sixteen thirty is the scheduled update, not proof of any particular resolution outcome.

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F2. Which record would invent an event?

A. Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it

Failure to locate an item is not evidence that the customer collected it.

Return to the exercise, page 88

F / Guided speaking

1. C17

Outgoing lead: The order reference is C17.

Turn 1. C17 identifies the particular pickup order that needs the handoff.

2. desk lamp

Jun: The missing item is the desk lamp.

Turn 2. The desk lamp is the unstaged item, not one of the three already prepared.

3. Jun

Outgoing lead: The next contact owner is Jun.

Turn 3. Jun is explicitly assigned responsibility for contacting the customer after the handoff.

4. 18:00

Jun: The next case update is at 18:00.

Turn 4. Eighteen hundred is the update checkpoint, not a guaranteed completion time.

Return to the conversation, page 89

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "You will own the customer contact after the shift change. Shall we set a review at half past four?" Evan: [missing response] Talia: "If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Yes. I am the action owner, and I will update the case at sixteen thirty. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising the mug will be found by then.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Talia says: "The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Evan's response in turn 14. It connects Talia's preceding point with Talia's follow-up. Action owner identifies Evan as responsible for the next customer contact, preventing the task from being lost between shifts.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Talia says: "Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Talia says: "That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant. Which term fits?

C. stock-keeping unit (SKU)

A Not here. core line: A recurring product line central to the offer. The usual combination is "replenish a core line".

B Not here. weeks of cover: Stock expressed in weeks at a specified sales rate. The usual combination is "assess weeks of cover".

C Correct. stock-keeping unit (SKU): An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant. The usual combination is "rationalize the SKU count".

D Not here. full-price sale: A sale at the regular undiscounted price. The usual combination is "protect full-price sales".

Return to the exercise, page 24

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison. Which term fits?

D. promotional uplift

A Not here. selling price: The amount charged per unit before specified adjustments. The usual combination is "set the selling price".

B Not here. price elasticity: The responsiveness of quantity demanded to price changes. The usual combination is "estimate price elasticity".

C Not here. redemption rate: The proportion using an offer among a defined eligible base. The usual combination is "calculate redemption rate".

D Correct. promotional uplift: An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison. The usual combination is "measure promotional uplift".

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Equal revenue, different stock exposure". Inez: "Some sizes may be carrying the leftovers. We should see whether the original distribution matched what customers actually selected." Cal: [missing response] Inez: "I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Then review the size curve. That may support changing quantities within the range rather than removing every option. We need the variant-level data before deciding.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Inez says: "Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Cal's response in turn 10. It connects Inez's preceding point with Inez's follow-up. The size curve describes the unit distribution across sizes, which may explain uneven leftover stock.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Inez says: "B did sell forty more units. I do not want the team to lose sight of that demand when we review the range." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Inez says: "Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "What percentage should the margin line show?" Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "I will report the volume gain and the lower gross profit, then list customer acquisition as an unanswered question." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. The gross margin percentage is approximately twenty-nine point four percent, down from forty. That is a revenue-based ratio, not the twenty-five-percent change in gross profit dollars.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hugo says: "That gives five thousand one hundred dollars, compared with five thousand in the normal week." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Hugo says: "We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 18. It connects Hugo's preceding point with Hugo's follow-up. Gross margin percentage divides gross profit by revenue; fifteen hundred over fifty-one hundred is approximately twenty-nine point four percent.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Hugo says: "We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Stock already allocated to existing demand. Which term fits?

D. committed inventory

A Not here. backorder: Unfilled demand awaiting stock under the applicable arrangement. The usual combination is "manage a backorder".

B Not here. replenishment: Restocking to support future sales or demand. The usual combination is "schedule replenishment".

C Not here. reorder point: The stock position that triggers replenishment under a policy. The usual combination is "set a reorder point".

D Correct. committed inventory: Stock already allocated to existing demand. The usual combination is "protect committed inventory".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: An event interrupting the expected delivery process. Which term fits?

C. delivery exception

A Not here. tracking number: An identifier used to follow a shipment. The usual combination is "provide the tracking number".

B Not here. refund authorization: Approval to return the relevant payment. The usual combination is "confirm refund authorization".

C Correct. delivery exception: An event interrupting the expected delivery process. The usual combination is "investigate a delivery exception".

D Not here. fulfillment: The process of preparing and completing an order's supply. The usual combination is "track order fulfillment".

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit". Hugo: "We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs." Nia: [missing response] Hugo: "We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. The unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hugo says: "That gives five thousand one hundred dollars, compared with five thousand in the normal week." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 10. It connects Hugo's preceding point with Hugo's follow-up. Unit gross profit subtracts the thirty-dollar product cost from each selling price, producing twenty dollars and twelve fifty.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Hugo says: "Units were up twenty percent. I have called that a profit improvement in the trading note. Can you check the wording before I send it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Hugo says: "The buyer mentioned possible supplier funding. Do we have an agreed amount, or should I leave it out of this result?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "Please still call at two if you have not heard back. I need time to arrange something else for the event." Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "Thank you. I need a clear position so I can decide what to do about the event." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will. The service recovery note will include your concern, the inquiry, and the outstanding answer. You should not have to start the explanation again with another agent.

A Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 18. It connects Laila's preceding point with Laila's follow-up. Service recovery concerns addressing the customer experience after the delay, including accountable follow-up and checking available remedies.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Laila says: "Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Laila says: "Does the record show that you sent it, or only that someone printed a label?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Laila says: "What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout. Which term fits?

B. checkout abandonment

A Not here. payment failure: An unsuccessful payment attempt under the relevant process. The usual combination is "investigate payment failures".

B Correct. checkout abandonment: Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout. The usual combination is "investigate checkout abandonment".

C Not here. deduplication: Identifying and handling repeated records of the same event. The usual combination is "validate deduplication".

D Not here. random assignment: Allocation by chance to comparison groups. The usual combination is "verify random assignment".

Return to the exercise, page 68

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms. Which term fits?

D. purchase order

A Not here. vendor scorecard: A report comparing supplier performance against defined measures. The usual combination is "correct a vendor scorecard".

B Not here. seller of record: The party identified as the seller for the transaction. The usual combination is "identify the seller of record".

C Not here. acceptance criterion: A requirement used to determine whether goods meet expectations. The usual combination is "confirm the acceptance criterion".

D Correct. purchase order: A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms. The usual combination is "reconcile the purchase order".

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Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "An expired estimate needs an honest next step". Laila: "Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?" Tomas: [missing response] Laila: "Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I mean I will contact you. The latest tracking event may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Laila says: "My order was due yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking has stopped changing. Can you tell me whether the carrier actually has it?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Tomas's response in turn 10. It connects Laila's preceding point with Laila's follow-up. Tracking event is a recorded shipment milestone; checking it supports an update without guaranteeing a future arrival.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Laila says: "I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Laila says: "The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 68

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "I will separate the metric correction from the quality investigation and the commercial discussion." Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "I will republish both denominators, the July period, and the corrected percentages. The ten affected units will remain visible." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That works. We can agree a remediation plan when the findings support the actions. Let us not promise a packaging change merely to close the meeting.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Rosa says: "Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Rosa says: "The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Rosa says: "The receiving file has eight hundred units from K and two hundred from M." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 18. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Remediation plan sets out actions addressing the problem once the evidence supports what needs to change.

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: A discretionary departure from policy where permitted. Which term fits?

A. goodwill exception

A Correct. goodwill exception: A discretionary departure from policy where permitted. The usual combination is "request a goodwill exception".

B Not here. misdescription: A mismatch between an item and its stated description. The usual combination is "investigate misdescription".

C Not here. case owner: The person responsible for coordinating the case. The usual combination is "identify the case owner".

D Not here. original payment method: The payment route used for the original purchase. The usual combination is "verify the original payment method".

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2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Placing picked items in the designated holding area. Which term fits?

D. staging

A Not here. cancellation line: An order item recorded for cancellation under the process. The usual combination is "confirm a cancellation line".

B Not here. omnichannel: Coordinated retail activity across store and digital channels. The usual combination is "coordinate omnichannel execution".

C Not here. order-level status: The overall state recorded for the complete order. The usual combination is "correct order-level status".

D Correct. staging: Placing picked items in the designated holding area. The usual combination is "confirm order staging".

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Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The supplier with more defects has the lower rate". Rosa: "Does the lower rate mean K has better quality overall?" Malik: [missing response] Rosa: "The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. It is a lower observed rate, but we need to compare product mix and inspection intensity before making that broader claim. I would not use the corrected arithmetic to dismiss the ten units.

A Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 10. It connects Rosa's preceding point with Rosa's follow-up. Product mix describes the goods included; different products can limit a claim about inherent comparative supplier quality.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Rosa says: "Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Rosa says: "Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Rosa says: "You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 90

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf". Talia: "I will leave P64 open with two staged items, the missing mug, the incorrect ready message, and the search history." Evan: [missing response] Talia: "That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Add those points to the discrepancy log. I will correct the customer-facing position through the approved process and make the offered options explicit when we speak.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Talia says: "The mug has not been found. The notebook and pen set are identified for P64 and are already in the designated holding area." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Evan's response in turn 18. It connects Talia's preceding point with Talia's follow-up. Discrepancy log preserves the mismatch between physical items and system status, together with ownership and follow-up information.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Talia says: "If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Talia says: "Can I hand over P64 before I leave? It says ready online, but I can only account for the notebook and pen set on the pickup shelf." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. settlement statement

Turn 2. The settlement statement connects the captured sales to refunds, fees, reserved funds, and the issued payout; the difference is not automatically missing money.

2. processing fees

Turn 4. The processing fees are the stated $300 deduction; unlike the reserve, they are nonrefundable under this fictional statement's terms.

3. reserve hold

Turn 6. The reserve hold sets aside $200 rather than paying it out now; it is distinct from the nonrefundable $300 fee and has no supplied release date.

4. bank receipt

Turn 10. Bank receipt confirms the funds actually reached the bank; an issued marketplace payout is a different processing stage and is not sufficient evidence of receipt.

5. reserve release

Turn 14. A reserve release makes previously held funds available; it does not create a new customer sale, and any later deductions still need reconciliation.

6. reconciliation trail

Turn 18. A reconciliation trail preserves how each adjustment connects the source statement to the payout and bank record, making later differences traceable.

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Transfer exchange

1. 1,850

Manager: Sales less the refunds equal 1,850 dollars.

Turn 1. Two thousand captured sales less one hundred fifty refunded leaves one thousand eight hundred fifty.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. 1,670

Analyst: After fees and the reserve, the issued payout is 1,670 dollars.

Turn 2. Subtracting the one-hundred-dollar fee and eighty-dollar reserve from 1,850 gives 1,670.

3. unconfirmed

Manager: Bank receipt is still unconfirmed.

Turn 3. The statement establishes issuance only; no bank record of receipt has been supplied.

4. sale

Analyst: Releasing the reserve would not create a new sale.

Turn 4. The reserve contains existing transaction funds, so its later release is not another customer purchase.

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Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. variant SKU

Turn 2. The variant SKU identifies the specific internal item: HT-BL-L is blue/large, while HT-BL-M is blue/medium with no available units.

2. item group ID

Turn 4. The item group ID groups genuine variants of the same product; it does not replace each variant's distinct identifier or merge their stock quantities.

3. size attribute

Turn 6. The size attribute must describe the offered variant; here large is correct and medium in the title is the mismatch needing correction.

4. landing-page selection

Turn 10. The landing-page selection must correspond to the advertised variant; a large listing linked to a preselected medium option still creates a mismatch.

5. GTIN

Turn 12. The Global Trade Item Number is a product identifier assigned under the applicable system; the verified large-variant GTIN must not be replaced with medium's merely to make grouped rows match.

6. processed feed

Turn 16. The processed feed shows what the destination accepted after ingestion; saving the source file alone does not establish the final displayed offer.

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Transfer exchange

1. RC-L

Merchandiser: The twelve available units belong to SKU RC-L.

Turn 1. The supplied inventory assigns all twelve units to the large variant, identified internally as RC-L.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. RED-CAP

Specialist: The shared group identifier is RED-CAP.

Turn 2. Both genuine variants belong to RED-CAP, while retaining their own distinct item identities.

3. 0

Merchandiser: Medium's available quantity remains 0.

Turn 3. Correcting a title does not move or create stock for the medium variant.

4. GTIN

Specialist: Correct the large row's title, not its already verified GTIN.

Turn 4. The case verifies the large identifier, so changing it merely to match an erroneous title would introduce another error.

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Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. product discount

Turn 2. The product discount takes twenty percent from the original $100 product price, leaving $80 before the order discount is calculated.

2. order discount

Turn 4. The order discount is ten percent of the already reduced $80 merchandise subtotal, so it removes $8 under the supplied combination rules.

3. shipping threshold

Turn 8. The shipping threshold is assessed after both discounts in this fictional offer; the relevant subtotal is $72, below the $75 minimum.

4. merchandise subtotal

Turn 10. The merchandise subtotal is $72 after both discounts, while the final payable total is $77 after adding the separate $5 shipping charge.

5. combination eligibility

Turn 14. Combination eligibility determines whether the two offers may apply together; the supplied test allows this combination, but that does not establish other discount pairings.

6. checkout summary

Turn 18. The checkout summary records the applied discounts, shipping basis, and payable total; it allows the displayed offer to be checked against the actual calculation.

Return to the conversation, page 103

Transfer exchange

1. 150

Executive: After the product discount, the subtotal is 150 dollars.

Turn 1. Twenty-five percent off two hundred removes fifty dollars, leaving one hundred fifty.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. 135

Analyst: After the order discount, merchandise costs 135 dollars.

Turn 2. Ten percent of the reduced one-hundred-fifty subtotal is fifteen, leaving one hundred thirty-five.

3. below

Executive: Shipping is charged because that subtotal is below the threshold.

Turn 3. The post-discount subtotal of 135 is below the stated 140-dollar free-shipping threshold.

4. 141

Analyst: Including shipping, the total is 141 dollars.

Turn 4. The one-hundred-thirty-five merchandise subtotal plus six-dollar shipping equals one hundred forty-one.

Return to the conversation, page 106

Find a phrase by purpose

Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Open the comparison: Both ranges generated $12,000 in the same four weeks.

Define the measure: Here, sell-through uses units sold divided by opening stock.

State the stronger rate: Range A sold through at eighty percent.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Acknowledge volume: The promotion sold twenty percent more units.

Correct the inference: That does not by itself establish higher profit.

State the new price: The promotional price was $42.50.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Identify the item: We are checking SKU L42.

Timestamp the quantity: This is the inventory position at 09:00.

Separate physical and sellable stock: One hundred units are on hand, but only thirty are available.

Full phrase bank, page 29

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Acknowledge the missed estimate: The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order.

Recognize the impact: I understand that you need the item for an event.

State the verified milestone: The carrier physically received the parcel on 4 May.

Full phrase bank, page 39

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

State the observed result: Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent.

Use the correct absolute unit: That is a decline of eight percentage points.

Give the relative comparison: Relative to the original rate, the decline is twenty percent.

Full phrase bank, page 51

Marketplace and Vendor Management

Ask for the base: What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?

State the period: Both figures refer to July receipts.

Clarify the counted object: Count each defective unit once, not every fault separately.

Full phrase bank, page 61

Customer Service and Escalations

Acknowledge the request: You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind.

Identify the timing: This request is on day thirty-five.

State the policy carefully: The stated change-of-mind window for this purchase is thirty days.

Full phrase bank, page 73

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Start with the order: This handoff concerns pickup order P64.

State the verified items: The notebook and pen set are located and staged.

Name the gap: The mug has not been found.

Full phrase bank, page 83

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] Federal Trade Commission. Business Guide to the Mail, Internet, or Telephone Order Merchandise Rule.

Background on shipment promises and delay obligations. Shipment and delivery are distinguished; the fictional carrier-delay case is not a complete legal procedure. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/business-guide-ftcs-mail-internet-or-telephone-order-merchandise-rule

[2] Shopify Help Center. Understanding inventory states.

Background on on-hand, available, committed, unavailable, and incoming quantities. The fictional inventory case states its own quantities and location scope. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/products/inventory/fundamentals/inventory-states

[3] Google Analytics Help. About ecommerce metrics.

Background on event-level and item-level measures. The checkout case explicitly defines its own denominator rather than implying a universal platform conversion metric. Source checked 1 October 2026.

https://support.google.com/analytics/answer/13428834?hl=en

> **Companion course**
>
> The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.
>
> https://englishladder.com/efsp-retail-ecommerce.html

Explain the offer. Trace the order. Make the numbers meaningful.

Eight commercial conversations: compare ranges, examine a promotion, locate sellable stock, explain a delivery delay, investigate checkout performance, challenge a vendor scorecard, handle a return request, and repair a pickup handoff.

Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Sell-through definitions differ. This case uses units sold divided by opening units, with no other stock movements. A is 80%; B is 60%. Do not quietly substitute revenue or remaining units as the denominator.

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Units rose 20%, while price fell 15%. Revenue changes multiplicatively: 1.20 times 0.85 equals 1.02, a 2% increase. Subtracting the two percentages would incorrectly give 5%.

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

On hand is not the same as available. Here the 100 warehouse units comprise 60 committed, ten held, and 30 available. The 20 incoming units are additional expected stock, not stock already received.

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

A shipping label alone does not prove carrier possession. This case does establish physical handoff. Shipment on 4 May still does not establish delivery on 6 May or any revised arrival time.

Phil Stilwell

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